

A Detailed Commentary on the Hymn of Extraordinary Praise

Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā · Toh 1110 · Derge Tengyur

ཁད་པར་དུ་འཕགས་པའི་བེན་པོ་ལྷོ་པའི་རི་རྒྱུ་རྒྱུ་བཤད་པ།

Toh 1110 in the Tengyur is a Sanskrit and Tibetan commentary known in Sanskrit as the Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā and in Tibetan as the Khyad par du 'phags pa'i bstod pa'i rgya cher bshad pa, rendered in English as A Detailed Commentary on the Hymn of Extraordinary Praise. It is an explanatory treatise that provides a full, verse-by-verse exegesis of a hymn of praise to the Buddha composed by a brahmin named Mthobtsun Drubjé, who is said to have converted to the Buddha's teaching and expressed his devotion in poetic form. The commentary unfolds both the narrative background and the doctrinal meaning of the hymn, situating the praise within a broader religious and literary context. As a work of exegetical literature devoted to a stotra, or hymn of praise, it belongs to the class of commentarial texts preserved in the Tengyur, the canonical collection of Indian and Tibetan scholarly treatises that accompanies the Kangyur.

In the language of India: Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā. In the language of Tibet: A Detailed Commentary on the Hymn of Extraordinary Praise.

Homage to the Blessed One Mañjuśrī in his youthful form.

Possessed of extraordinary distinction,
Worshipped by the gods — to that buddha

I bow: this hymn of noble praise

shall now be explained according to its meaning and in proper order.

There was a brahmin named Mthobtsun Drubjé, learned in the four Vedas and held in highest esteem by the brahmin community. He gained faith in the teaching of the Blessed One and composed this hymn in praise of the buddha, the Blessed One.

The story behind it is as follows, as it has been passed down by hearing. In the eastern lands there lived a brahmin of the highest class, born into a brahmin lineage devoted to the six duties, having entered upon a life of good conduct by virtue of merit accumulated in former lives. From that family were born two brothers named Mthobtsun Drubjé and Debjé Dakpo. Both came to master all the treatises.

At that time the two brothers reflected in this way: "In our household we worship the Great God (Śiva), yet the scripture of the buddha, the Blessed One, appears to be supremely excellent. We must therefore examine with certainty whether the Great God is the more exalted, or whether it is the buddha, the Blessed One." Having heard that the Great God was visibly present on Mount Kailash together with Umā and the supreme bull, they resolved: "Let us go there, and we shall do as the Great God instructs us." They then set out swiftly, making great effort, aided along the way by gods, until they reached the level ground of Mount Kailash. There they beheld the supreme bull of the Great God, which hung suspended in the air like a piece of white cloud. The sight filled them with great delight, and immediately after they saw the goddess Umā in a grove of fruit trees heavy with their fruits. They paid homage to her reverently, and from her retinue they heard the words: "Your lord resides in a grove of blossoming flowers." Their minds were filled with great joy, and they entered that delightful ground scattering loose flowers as an offering. They then saw the Great God, possessed of great wealth, seated upon his throne and surrounded by an assembly of a thousand attendants. No sooner had they seen him than the lord of the assembly took them by the hand, led them before him, and they paid homage with reverence. He asked them: "From where have you come?" The two brothers told him everything in full as it had occurred.

Then, just as the time for the monks' meal was approaching, five hundred arhats who dwelt in a cool lake, wearing robes the colour of damp earth, descended from the sky like flocks of red-winged birds swooping down. The Great God then, together with his assembled retinue, took up incense, ointments, and offerings, and proceeded toward them. He seated each one on his respective throne, draped precious robes over them one by one so that they sat in comfort, and fully satisfied them with food, drink, and sweets. Umā too made offerings of flowers and fruit, and they listened to teachings on the Dharma. When the arhats had departed again, the Great God spoke to the two brothers: "I know the purpose for which you have come here, and I shall speak to you of it.

The teacher whose disciple we gladly worship each day, possessed of supreme qualities,
renowned as the foremost of names adorned with the great quality of dispelling the world's faults —

When one makes offerings with a mind of utmost joy, one feels as though one has reached nirvāṇa. The buddha who is the teacher of all three realms, possessed of unmatched qualities — he is the one the wise worship. Therefore it is that very Teacher of yours, and his sacred scriptures, that you should honor.

Having come to this understanding, the two brothers returned to their own land. Knowing that the scriptures of the Tathāgata are without any fault, they cast aside the words of the Vedas as if they were so much grass, went forth into the renunciant life, and composed two praises of the buddha Blessed One: the Praise of Supreme Excellence and the Praise Surpassing the Gods.

Now, wishing to explain the meaning of the individual parts of the first verse, the text begins: "I, having abandoned all other teachers..." — this verse was spoken because of the concern that others might say: "Why is it that, having realized the reality of all treatises without exception, you have abandoned teachers such as the brahmins (serkya), those who eat from the fire (gzegzan), the naked ascetics (rkangmig), and the like, along with the teachings established by them, and now enter upon the Blessed One the Buddha and his teaching?" And so this verse was spoken: "I, having abandoned all other teachers, have come to take refuge in you, the Blessed One — and why? Because you are without fault, and you are endowed with qualities."

Here, "I" refers to the one who praises — the author himself. "Teacher" is one who corrects and disciplines, and this refers to the brahmins and the like. "Having abandoned" means having thoroughly given up and discarded them. "Blessed One" is an address: it refers to one who has destroyed the mental afflictions — the attachment and other afflictions together with their habitual tendencies — and the word "destroyed" is the term applied to that destroying; the one who possesses this destroying is the "Blessed One." "You" refers to the buddha, the Blessed One.

What is the nature of that one? "Refuge" is what was said, meaning "support" — specifically, one upon whom relying causes all misconduct to become exhausted. "Have come" means to have approached and entered. The meaning is: those who have accumulated many forms of misconduct — such as faithlessness and the like — by confessing them fully to the Blessed One, become free of their sins and are reborn in the higher realms. This is the illustration to be applied here.

As for what is the reason for abandoning other teachers and taking refuge in that Teacher, that is what is addressed by the words "and why?" and what follows: because you are without faults and you are endowed with qualities. Now, one who possesses no fault — such as habitual tendencies and the like — is one who is "without fault." And since the afflictions injure body, speech, and mind, they are "faults," meaning the mental afflictions. "Qualities" refers to the powers and fearlessnesses and so forth. One who possesses those without equal is one who is "endowed with qualities" — and that one is you. This is the meaning.

If the Blessed One the Buddha is himself without fault and endowed with supremely excellent qualities, why then do some, abandoning the Blessed One, rely instead on brahmins and others? And so this verse was spoken:

Because the world delights in faults
and clings to holding onto qualities,
it sees even faults as though they were qualities
and so takes refuge in another.

Here "the world" means ordinary, common sentient beings — for the noble ones do not delight in faults. "World" is a definitive term, meaning those who are attached to sense objects. "Delights in faults" means rejoicing in and inclining toward things that are worthy of blame. Alternatively, though this world does not take delight in faults as such,

rather, the meaning is that it enters into apprehending whatever is a fault as though it were a quality. For example, an eye afflicted by the disease of bile sees the beautiful whiteness of the moon's rays as yellow, and thinks to itself, "We see and perceive the color as yellow." In the same way, through the fault of associating with unwholesome spiritual companions and listening to what is not the genuine Dharma, the mind becomes confused and comes to apprehend even someone's faults as though they were qualities.

As for the phrase "clings to holding onto qualities," it means taking up qualities and thereby grasping at qualities — which is to say, the meaning is apprehending things as having qualities. And that which has become inferior in its grasping at qualities is what is meant by being foolish and deluded. In this connection, the phrase "delights in faults" indicates that the mental continuum has been made impure by the fault of inversion. The phrase "sees even faults as though they were qualities" indicates that beings, being without discernment and confused by conceptual thought, grasp in this way.

As for how one can ascertain what was explained above — that is why the passage beginning with "in another" and so forth is stated, with the meaning being that people go for refuge in others such as the Great God (Śiva), Viṣṇu, Brahmā, and the like. This verse will demonstrate the following: since worldly people possess no genuine qualities but have accumulated many faults, their going for refuge in others makes it certain that they desire a teacher who is other than the true Teacher.

When asked how these others are possessed of faults and lack qualities, the passage beginning with "Viṣṇu" and so forth is stated. The god of wealth and the great lord of sovereignty refers to Viṣṇu, the sovereign lord, along with those of that ilk. Faith in these — meaning whatever qualities those who rejoice in them and are greatly devoted to them proclaim abroad, and whatever distinctive excellences they publicly extol — those very things are faults within your teaching, O Buddha, Blessed One. That is to say, within your teaching they are faults, failings, impoverishments, and grounds for reproach.

When asked what qualities of theirs one proclaims given that they are faults within your teaching, the passage beginning with "the Great God" and so forth provides the answer. "The Great God in his fury" refers to his mental continuum being pervaded by consuming rage. "The triple city" refers to the destruction of the triple city, in which three cities were combined into one, and his burning it with fierce power. "Fierce" indicates that this can be proclaimed as a quality. And this is how the quality of the Great God is proclaimed and demonstrated in the world: a triple city of the asuras appeared, roaming through the sky; the asuras descended from it and did harm to human beings. Then the Great God, in order to protect those human beings, took up his bow and with a single arrow burned the triple city of the asuras. This is as it is said:

Here the asuras' city roamed through the sky,
filled with men and women, old and young alike.

Taking up the great bow, with a blazing arrow
he burned it in an instant, as if consuming it with fire.

Now this — killing living beings — is, within your teaching, a great fault,
because it leads to falling into hell. As it is also said:

Whatever one you see performing the act of killing,
from which there is no turning back — that extreme...

"Know now that you are bound
for hell, alas, to go this very day."

So it is said in a sūtra.

Now, if the burning of the asura city by the Great God (Śiva) was indeed a fault, then what, one might ask, is the burning that possesses virtue in your teaching? To that question one speaks of "yours," and so forth. What weapon is meant? It is the great arrow of primordial wisdom — for primordial wisdom itself is the great arrow, and so it is called the great arrow of primordial wisdom. As for "the fire of wrath," since wrath itself is like a mother, it is called the fire of wrath. The meaning is that the Blessed One thoroughly burned and thereby brought about the pacification of that very thing. An objection is raised: is it not the great sovereign power of loving-kindness that pacifies the fire of wrath? For did not the Blessed One declare, "Monks, cultivate loving-kindness. Through relying upon, meditating upon, and thoroughly practicing loving-kindness, you will come to abandon aversion"? That is so; yet loving-kindness can only soothe wrath, whereas primordial wisdom uproots it entirely — and this is precisely why primordial wisdom is spoken of here.

As for "but the Great God's burning was faulty burning," this means that it was not burned well — it was not burned from the root. This is being taught: by reason of having burned with that faulty burning which was defective, the Great God was in turn summoned and brought under control by desire itself. And the story goes like this: once, on account of actions such as burning the triple city, the Great God felt deep revulsion and, wishing to purify those transgressions, he withdrew to dwell in a hermitage in a mountain cleft among the snowy peaks, abiding in his vow of austerity. At that time, when the God of Desire attempted to obstruct him, the Great God said, "Do not harm me." But the God of Desire went ahead and harmed him, whereupon the Great God, his mind tormented by blazing wrath, burned the God of Desire with fire drawn out through his third eye so completely that not even ash remained. Then again, the God of Desire, through the enchanting coquetry of the lower body of the corpse of his beloved who had not been able to dissuade the Great God, kept obstructing him ceaselessly.

As for the phrase "with the force of your wisdom entering in," it refers to the fire of your primordial wisdom. "Utterly accomplished from the root" means that there is no remainder yet to be attained — the meaning being "together with habitual tendencies." "Burned and expelled" means removed in such a manner that it can never arise again.

As for "the Great God, enamored of Tiglemakma" and what follows, the story heard is as follows: there were two asura brothers named Sundha and Upasundha. Those two propitiated Brahmā and came to be such that the three worlds could not overcome them. They then said, "Though our bodies are separate, let there be no difference in our minds — make it so that we are not separate." Brahmā granted this supreme boon. Then the two undertook the task of conquering the three realms. The gods deliberated on a means of killing those two, and Brahmā said, "Contrive a means by which they will kill each other." So the gods, drawing from their own bodies a radiance as fine as sesame seed by sesame seed, created from it a divine maiden called Tiglemakma, and caused her to circle around Brahmā. When he looked at her form, his mind was swept away with distraction, and in his embarrassment he emanated four faces. In the same way, the Great God too, overcome by attachment, emanated four faces. Hence it is said:

The Great God, enamored of Tiglemakma,
grew four faces.

Here "the Great God" refers to the one who bears the weapon with three prongs. "Tiglemakma" is the divine maiden. "Attachment having arisen" means: having entered into the arising of a thought of attachment.

"Grew four faces" means: he became one with four faces.

Furthermore, it is said of the Blessed One:

By the coquetry of Māra's daughters,
not even the tip of a single hair on your body was stirred.

"Daughters related to Māra" means Māra's daughters — referring to Tṛṣṇā and Ratī together with their retinues. Their coquetry is characterized by laughing and speaking, glancing sideways, and dancing. Yet even by that, "your" — meaning you, O Protector — "not even the tip of a single hair on your body was stirred or altered." This teaches that when the Blessed One was seated at the Vajra Seat (Bodh Gayā), not even at the ordinary worldling's level were those daughters able to arouse desire in him.

Regarding the passage beginning "the Great God, one half," the phrase "one half" refers to the female half of his body — because he holds and embraces the goddess Umā, he is called "the Anguished One," and although he strives, he cannot prevail, for that body belongs to two separate beings. Here is the story: when the Great God was experiencing the pleasures of desire together

with Umā for a thousand years, and the moment of emission approached, he thought, "For now, with one side of my body I have enjoyed sensual pleasure; let Umā now, out of her own willing delight, enter the other half of my body, so that I may experience a distinctive bliss." And so the half-body became known as "the Lord of Women." Furthermore, the line "you who bring pleasure" means: do not be bewildered by that very desire which causes confusion — the meaning being, "not having become confused and attached."

Regarding the passage beginning "the one with the wheel and the short spear": "the one who has the wheel" is the wheel-bearer — meaning Viṣṇu, who wields the discus weapon. "The one with the short spear" is the Great God, who wields the trident. "The force of Māra" means Māra's army of thirty-six billion. "The Victor" means the one who overwhelms and subdues — the one who cannot be brought under control. The line "you prevail without Viṣṇu's discus or the Great God's spear, victorious with the weapon of loving-kindness" teaches this: to prevail over the force of Māra, you overcome and vanquish manifestly even without the discus of Viṣṇu and the spear of the Great God, through the weapon of loving-kindness.

Regarding the passage beginning "the old one": the line "the old one struck Viṣṇu with an arrow" — the story behind this is as follows. The relatives and companions of Viṣṇu were gathered in some place drinking ale, and a sage happened to approach that wretched spot. Unable to hold back, Viṣṇu thought, "I shall mock this sage," and taking the form of a woman, went before him. Having performed an act of reverence toward him, she then showed him a bowl strapped and bound against her belly, and said, "What is inside this of mine? What will come of it?" The sage, perceiving through the power of his meditative concentration, became filled with great and fierce anger, and cursed them all: "May there come forth from your belly an iron pestle that will destroy the entire lineage of Viṣṇu without remainder." And so in due time an iron pestle did indeed come forth. The entire lineage of Viṣṇu came together and ground that iron pestle down against water and stone, and cast it into a swampy pond mixed with sand and silt. And that too became a stand of reeds in the marsh.

Yet from that iron pestle one small splinter had remained. Thinking, "What harm can this do?" they cast it into the river. It was swallowed by a fish, and the fish was caught by a fisherman who sold it to an old hunter. When he split open the fish, the iron splinter emerged, and he fitted it as the tip to his arrow.

Now, as time passed, the terror of destruction wrought by the curse drew near. The kinsmen of Viṣṇu gathered at the bank of that pond, drunk on wine and noisy and rowdy, and maddened by the curse, a great quarrel broke out. They began to beat one another with reeds pulled from the marsh, and all the kindred of Viṣṇu were destroyed, all but Viṣṇu himself who was absent. Then Viṣṇu thought: "My consort's retinue of sixteen thousand dwells in the city of Gopāla. Should it come to pass that the curse causes them to harm one another, or that they are carried off by others?" And so he dispatched the minister Siddhārtha. Siddhārtha gathered them all and set out, saying he would bring them before Viṣṇu. But when the mountaineer brigands heard of this, they armed themselves with various weapons and came to do battle with Siddhārtha. They exhausted and stripped away every last weapon of Siddhārtha's retinue and seized everyone. When Viṣṇu heard this, he could not contain the anguish in his heart, and so, with a grief-stricken mind, he went off to the wilderness to dispel that sorrow.

There, in a place of very dense thickets, overcome by grief, he lay down with his whole body upon the ground. As he lay with his legs stretched out, his great toe was moving. Now it happened that the old hunter had entered the forest to stalk game, and was waiting quietly with his attention fixed on watching for animals. Seeing the movement of the toe, he thought it was the ear of a deer twitching, loosed his arrow, and took Viṣṇu's life.

As for the word "the old one," it refers to the old hunter. As for the name "Viṣṇu," he is the son of Nṛpe. As for "by an arrow," it is by the hunter's arrow. As for "struck," it means slain.

Now, as to the verse line "the Great God (Śiva) whose throat turned blue": the Great God is Maheśvara, and his throat became blue because he was overcome by poison. This came about as follows. When the gods entered into the churning of the ocean, at that time the jewel Kaustubha, the horse Uccaiṣṛavas, and many other things arose from the ocean. And then a poison arose, and by its power, while Viṣṇu was present in the proximity of that poison, the color of his skin turned dark. The Great God took it up and, having no fear, began to swallow it, whereupon it stuck in his throat, going neither upward nor downward, and his throat appeared like the throat of a peacock. The gods then said: "This is exceedingly beautiful — from this day forward it is fitting to leave it right there at his throat." Such is the account.

As for the phrase "towards these two gods," it refers to Viṣṇu and the Great God. As for "there is injury done," because one who dwells in injury is present, there is "injury done" — meaning one who is endowed with injury or killing done by another. As for "O Protector, you," it is an address to the Blessed One, the meaning being "O Master." Since there is no injury done, there is "one free of injury done."

The question arises: although the Blessed One has not suffered death at the hands of another, he has nonetheless suffered injury at the hands of another — namely, the wounding of his foot by a stone splinter at Vulture Peak Mountain.

To this, it is replied: that was merely a wound inflicted; it cannot be called "injury done." And the reason is this: "injury done" is said of harm that has been sustained over a long duration, not of something momentary. The Blessed One, in that very instant, was affected only to that slight degree — it is nothing like the Great God's (Śiva's) throat turning blue.

As for the verse "Viṣṇu, having transformed his form into that of a short man..." — the story is heard as follows. An asura (demigod) named Balī came forth, and by overpowering his own enemies he came to dominate all three realms without exception. At that point, Viṣṇu thought to himself: "I am unable to do battle with him directly, for he possesses exceedingly excellent heroic effort as a man. Therefore I must certainly deceive him through a trick." Having so deliberated, he transformed himself into the appearance of a short brahmin (brahmin being a priestly caste man of small stature) and, taking on the guise of a beggar, he went forth. At a time when King Balī was performing the vow of the horse sacrifice, Viṣṇu approached the one who was diligently calling out: "Who wants something? Who wants something? To whom shall what be given?" And he said: "I am making a fire offering for my father and mother; for that purpose, give me land equal to the measure of a single stride." Balī replied: "What need of yours could be satisfied by so little? Ask instead for elephants, horses, chariots, gold, and other such things, and I will give them to you, without refusal and with distinction." Yet Viṣṇu did not desire this. Then Balī said: "If that is what you wish, then at least take three strides." Whereupon Viṣṇu, with two strides, stretched one leg across the full extent of the three worlds, and failing to find a place for his third stride, and having accepted the burden of breaking his vow, he fell into despair; and because great fear destroyed all his own possessions, Balī was seized and bound beneath the earth.

"Short man" means one of short form. "Form" means body. "Having transformed" means having visibly emanated. By whom? By Viṣṇu. Was it by overpowering his enemy? No — the text says "by a deceptive means," meaning by a trick. "Baḷī" is the name of the king of the asuras. "Deceived" means "caused to fall from his sovereignty."

Now, one might think: "You, the Blessed One, do not deceive others — perhaps it is because you do not know trickery that you therefore do not deceive others." Against this objection, the text says "yet he too came to know trickery." This means: because he does know trickery, it is said "yet he too came to know trickery." For the Blessed One is omniscient; he knows all things, both defiled and undefiled in their entirety, yet that which is defiled he does not engage in. Here one should cite as an analogy the sūtra of the lord who holds the sword.

As for "O Protector, your miraculous powers..." — your miraculous powers are the Protector's miraculous powers: swift as thought and so forth. The display of these powers is their sport. Of what kind? "Wondrous" — meaning they give rise to amazement and wonder.

"Viṣṇu who strode across the three worlds" means crossing the three worlds with three strides. "The legless one" means one without legs — because it moves by crawling, it is a crawler; and because Viṣṇu acted similarly in entering, it is said "like a crawler." "Seeing" means understanding. This will be taught in the following verse:

One who has seen the wondrous display of your miraculous powers, O Protector, sees even Viṣṇu's striding across the three worlds — through the divine realm above and the underworld below — as no different from the crawling of a crawler. Why is this? It is because worldly people regard Jambudvīpa alone as constituting the three worlds: the world enclosed on four sides by the ocean up to the second world is the human world, the foundation below is the world of the nāgas, the mountains such as the Himālaya and other ranges where the gods dwell, and the stars and so forth constitute the divine world. That Viṣṇu crossed all this with his three strides is what is called "traversing the three worlds." The Blessed One, the Buddha, however, by the mere arising of his intention, swiftly passes through with the miraculous power swift as thought — through world-realms numbering many hundreds of thousands of the great thousandfold universe, to world-realms possessed of radiance beyond reckoning. This is the intended point of comparison.

As for "the youth who practises celibacy" — youth, Kārtika, cave-dweller, and peacock-rider are synonyms for the same figure. "Practises celibacy" means he has turned away from sexual conduct, and because he is free from the desire of sensual attachment, this is how he conducts himself, being bound. "Together with" means at the same time and in the same manner. Together with whom? "With Śaḍānana's wife" — that is, with his wife, she who is called Śaḍānana's. "Conduct" means to act or to guard one's conduct.

Now, this is what is heard concerning that matter. There was born a divine maiden, the highest consort of Śaḍānana, supremely beautiful in form, skilled in conduct, devoted to sensual enjoyment, and excelling others by her feminine qualities, surpassing all. The youth took her as his wife, and then a certain sage spoke to him: "If you seek to be victorious over the three worlds and intend to proclaim renowned fame of a special kind, then at this time you must undertake the vow called 'the edge of the sword.' This is that vow: though in the full bloom of youth, capable of experiencing sensual pleasure, you will sport with her who is the chief among all wives, she of exceedingly beautiful form; though you experience the pleasure of physical contact and so forth, you shall enter equanimity with the two regarded as without sensation." Having said, "If this vow is long maintained, it will bear fruit," from that point forward the youth undertook the vow.

As for "the union that you practised" and what follows — "union" (saṃyoga) carries the meaning of "the joining of two with two." And because one has become engaged in that union, it is union — that is, closely enjoying the conjunction with the joining. Therefore, "you made it as if to ashes" means that what was not ashes was made into ashes and destroyed.

Regarding this, the Blessed One spoke in the sūtra bearing the seven aspects of sexual union, saying: Among these brahmins, some claim to practise celibacy; yet though they do not physically join two with two with a woman, they fix their eyes on a woman and deliberately look at the visual form that is the object of the eye, they take that in, they think on it conceptually and cling to it, and remaining in that clinging — such a brahmin who claims to practise celibacy yet possesses the quality of union is indeed possessed of it, and is not without it; he practises celibacy that is not fully pure — he is one who has broken it, who is full of holes, who is led astray, who is defiled. He is of birth, of old age, and...

of sickness, of death, of grief, of lamentation, of suffering, of mental distress, and of misery — from all these he will not be fully liberated, and I do not declare that he is freed from suffering.

Furthermore, one who deliberately fixes his eyes on a woman, attending to the visual form that is the object of the eye, and who also looks — proceeding from that to playing together with her and to indulging in laughter and banter — that too is celibacy that is not fully pure, just as before.

Furthermore, one who also indulges in laughter and banter together with a woman, and who appropriates for himself the acts of anointing, massaging, and bathing performed by a woman, and indulges in these — that too is likewise.

Furthermore, one who similarly appropriates to himself, and who indulges in listening to the ornaments, the singing, the dancing, and so forth of women who are separated from him only by a wall or a screen — that too is likewise.

Furthermore, one who, even short of that, has indulged as far as the sounds, and who then looks upon others who are endowed with the five qualities of sensual pleasure and indulges in them, plays among them, and comes to experience them partaken of with delight — that too is likewise.

Furthermore, one who acts even up to that enjoyment, and who then recollects the laughter, the play, and the rejoicing in pleasures that he formerly experienced, appropriating those to himself as a memory — that too is likewise.

Furthermore, one who acts even up to recollection, and who dedicates whatever moral discipline, ascetic observance, austerity, or celibacy he has practised to a destination such as the realm of the gods — that celibate practice too is likewise impure.

All this is expanded upon at length in the passage beginning: "A brahmin who has not abandoned and not fully understood these seven aspects of the quality of union — I do not declare that he will pass beyond this world together with its gods."

As for the passage beginning "Brahmā and the rest are said to be," this means it is widely reported that Brahmā and the others speak thus: "I it is who draws forth the entire world of sentient beings and the receptacle world, and I am the one who sets my own Brahmā-conduct in motion" — that is the meaning. The word "said to be" indicates that this is nothing more than a tale passed on by

word of mouth.

As for "You who behold suchness" — the one who possesses the manner of beholding suchness (tattva) is the beholder of suchness; the meaning is "by that omniscient one."

If one asks what that omniscient one taught, the text says: "He taught that worlds exist, and that these too are born from karma." The worlds themselves, and what is described as giving rise to them — Brahmā and the rest — you have taught and declared that these too are born from karma.

And this also: "Sentient beings are born of karma, they live on karma's portion, they are connected to karma in all that follows — whatever wholesome or unwholesome karma they perform, it is from that very karma that they come to inherit their lot." This is declared in the sūtras.

As for the passage beginning "Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) was not free from agitation" — "Śakra" means the one who holds the vajra as his weapon; the meaning is "the Lord." "Without agitation" refers to the daughter of a sage, for it was upon seeing her that all of this arose. "Through desire" means through the attachment of the gods of the desire realm. "Bewildered" means fallen into confusion. "Said to be" indicates that this is a worldly tale.

The story is heard as follows: There was a sage named Gautama, and he had a wife named Ahalyā, who was possessed of the full bloom and glory of youth. Śakra became attached to her, and she in turn became attached to him, and so the two became involved with each other.

On a certain occasion, the sage was invited as a guest to another hermitage, and he went out to gather flowers, fuel wood, and kuśa grass. Śakra came there and was seen consorting openly and at ease with Ahalyā. Gautama, not yet fully aware of what had occurred, entered the hermitage, and Ahalyā, frightened and trembling, swallowed Śakra. Then Gautama took Ahalyā and went to attend the invitation at the other hermitage. The sage, by the power of his yogic insight, knew what had transpired and set out three seats. Gautama thought: why have three seats been laid? Upon investigating, he perceived that Śakra was present within Ahalyā's body. He felt ashamed, ate his meal, and returned to his own dwelling. He said to Ahalyā: "Vomit forth Śakra!" And she did so. He then cursed Śakra, saying: "May you be marked with a thousand female organs!" Thereupon the gods came and honored Gautama, and they offered him the boon: "May what you have said — that he be marked with a thousand female organs — become instead a thousand eyes." From that time

forth, Śakra came to have a thousand eyes.

As for the phrase "O Hero" and what follows: he is called a hero because he is endowed with the excellence of diligence. The address to the Blessed One is "O Hero." "Through desire alone" and "in order not to be deluded" mean: for the sake of thoroughly overcoming desire. "The consorts were sent away" means that sixty thousand consorts of the queen — Śrīmatī, Mṛgajānī, Śāmtomā, and the rest — were sent away and completely relinquished. As for "by the hand of Rāhu" and what follows: because he was seized by the very hand of Rāhu, it is said "by Rāhu's hand." The moon is marked by a hare. What kind of moon? Powerless — bereft of strength and capacity, without independence, having fallen under the power of another. "Seized" means held fast.

The story is heard thus: when the gods were churning the ocean of milk, nectar arose from it. The asura Rāhu seized and began to consume it. Viṣṇu thought: if this one drinks the nectar, all the gods will be unable to overcome him. So he severed his head with the discus. When Rāhu released it, the gods took it back. The nectar had permeated as far as the region of Rāhu's throat, and though the lower portion of his body died, he remained alive, and from then on he roams about in order to harm gods and humans. From that time forward, he seizes the sun, which illuminates the three worlds, and the moon.

As for "having gained sovereignty" and what follows: there is no sentient being or elemental spirit whatsoever that, being under the power of another, acts against you, O Protector, without freedom, and causes harm to you who are not under another's control. This is the meaning.

As for "lord of men" and what follows: Priyakara and Vastrapriya — that is, Priyakara and Vastrapriya and the like — the king among them, returning from the forest of austerities, wetted his mind with the moisture of desire and came back home again. This is the meaning of "came again from the grove."

The story is as follows: the king of thirty-three with ten chariots went to battle the asuras. His body was pierced by many wounds from the asuras' weapons, and he went to the city without fighting. His wife Kekayā nursed him back to health, and he granted her a boon in return.

Then, on another occasion, when the father was about to consecrate Priyakara to the kingdom, Kekayā, her mind disturbed by envy of the royal succession, said: "The god swore to grant me a boon —"

"I ask that Priyakara be banished to the forest for twelve years and that my son Bharata be consecrated to the kingdom." From the time that Priyakara went to the forest, he abducted Sītā, slew Rāvaṇa, and performed other such deeds. Then he entered the wandering palace known as "Flowered," and Bharata and the others offered prayers and worship to him. He went to the city without conflict, and Priyakara reveled in pleasures and happiness.

Other kings too, such as Gośreda, seeing a world afflicted and threatened by suffering, and thinking "I too shall come to such a condition," renounced the kingdom and went to the forest. When they later separated from that and found it unsuitable to remain in these great lands, they departed — all the people following — and with reverence made petition, inviting them back once more to the royal palace. And it is heard that those kings too, their minds drawn close to attachment and pleasure, returned again to the city.

The words "You, Sugata" are an address. The word "solitary" — though physical solitude too is known by the name solitude — here it is held that the term refers to the special quality of meditative absorption that produces both. That itself is the nectar of immortality, the ambrosia that prevents death. Because you became sated by it and went to the forest, you do not return again to the home. This is the meaning.

As for "sacrifice," and the words that follow: sacrifice means to offer and to give — the sacrifice of cattle and so forth. "Slaughter of animals" means the killing of livestock such as cattle, horses, and the like.

Who says such things? "The sages are said to declare it" — meaning that the ancient sages who consumed the oblation fire and so forth spoke thus.

"You who are without sin" — one in whom no sin exists is without sin, and this is an address to you who are thus without sin.

"Even toward the ant" — this refers to tiny creatures of very small body. "Causing harm" means killing. "Has not advised it" means that he did not speak thus, nor instruct that this should be done.

This is also elaborated at length in the Sūtra of the Dharma King: "Whatever terminal limit of not turning away from killing that you have not seen — that I have surely seen either as a hell or in other forms. Why is that? Because they have taken up and remain in those very dharmas that lead to hell."

As for the passage "Others, for the sake of their own benefit" and what follows: others such as those who consume the fire-offering do so for their own benefit

— that is, for their own advantage. By what means? "Through sacrifice," it says — by means of the knowledge of sacrifice. "The life of another" means that they take the life of other sentient beings, make it into the material of the sacrifice, and perform the offering. And such ritual of sacrifice, possessed as it is of harm toward sentient beings, shows by the teaching of the fire-sacrifice ceremony a thing close to burning one's own purpose or to killing oneself as the cause of obtaining the heavenly realms and the like. As it was said:

Seven thousand into the water,
eleven thousand into the fire —
as for those slain by the lord of men,
they are without number.

This was spoken by the Fearful One on the field of battle.

Again, "You, O Protector, for the sake of others" — meaning for the benefit of others. "You alone" means without a companion. "With your own life" means by that very livelihood of yours itself.

"Performed the fire sacrifice" means: he made of himself the material of the fire sacrifice, was burned, and thereby accomplished the benefit of others. Here, the Jātaka of the tigress and similar stories should be cited as examples.

Regarding "the sages' curse-fire": "sages" refers to the sages of old. "Curse-fire" means that the curse itself is like fire. In what way? As is said, "unbearable" — meaning terrifying. "Many people" means innumerable sentient beings. "Burned" means reduced to ash. Concerning this, the Blessed One said in the extensive sūtra: "What do you think, O assembly here present? Who was it that emptied and cleansed this hermitage of Mataka? It was, O Gautama, through the unbearable curse arising from the mental desire of the sages." So it is stated in the extensive sūtra. "And you are the Blessed One." "With the fire of gnosis" means: having burned and reduced to ash with the fire of wisdom. "People" refers to sentient beings. "The cause of rebirth" means the meaning of karma and affliction, which have become the cause for the manifest increase of one's own substantial existence. Regarding "the sages" and what follows: "accomplished in cursing" means possessing the power to curse. "Austerity" means religious observance. "Accomplished" means completed. "Can be inferred" means can be known. And this is how it is: at the time when they are able to cast their curses aside, one can know that those persons have completed their religious observance. At the time when they are unable to harm others or to curse them, they will not be regarded as

possessed of renown.

"O Protector, you" is an address to the Buddha, the Blessed One. "Accomplished in loving compassion" means fully perfected in compassion — the meaning being: having reached the culmination of the activity of accomplishing the benefit of others. Moreover, the activity of benefiting others in which one engages with heartfelt affection is described as loving compassion. "Accomplished in that" means performing the activity of accomplishing it — that is, performing the activity of benefiting others. "Accomplished in austerity" means: the religious observance is complete.

Regarding the verse beginning "The Great God (Śiva), bearing the mark of one possessed of desire," the account is as follows. It was heard afterward that in a certain forest of thorn trees, many sages were dwelling there, afflicted by the most severe austerities, accompanied by their sons, daughters, and wives. The goddess Umā, seeing their unbearable austerities, was moved by overwhelming pity for them. She went to the dwelling of the Great God and, in the privacy of that secluded place, spoke these words with composure: "These sages are striving to engage in great austerities, and since they desire liberation, it is fitting that you should cause them to attain liberation without fail."

The Great God replied: "The bliss of liberation is attained by sentient beings only through being free from attachment and aversion. Since these sages are not like that, how can you be certain that liberation should be given to them?"

Umā said: "Do not speak thus. Since they are certainly free from aversion, I entreat you on all accounts: please satisfy their bodies with the nectar-bliss of nirvāṇa."

Thereupon the Great God, having recognized with certainty Umā's intention, and having found arising within himself a surge of desire toward the daughters of the sages, thought to himself, "Let these ones be awakened for now," and so resolved. On the second day, adorned with a garland of flowers on his head, his body made firm and solid, abiding in the full bloom of youth, ornamented with extraordinarily alluring attire, he made his own substantial form appear youthful. Having covered his distinguishing marks, he went forth in a manner openly aroused and oozing, and approached the wives of the sages and

the young daughters emerging from the forest hermitage of the sages. Delighting exceedingly in touching and embracing their bodies, he entered into the grove of thośing trees, and they too, upon seeing him, found their

minds captivated. Gazing at one so supremely endowed with beauty, through the force of desire, both sides of their thighs became drenched with a flowing moisture, and they fell into a profound swoon.

Then the sages born of the forest hermitage, merely upon seeing this, were agitated in mind by the force of their fury, and they cursed him, saying: "You who are untamed, you whose faculties have been inflamed by desire — may your mark fall, may your mark fall!" Immediately following that curse, his mark fell to the ground, like the trunk of Śakra's elephant.

Now, when those sages were abiding in the power of meditative concentration, the goddess spoke: "This is the Great God. He has come here in order to awaken us." Understanding it just as it was, they took up that distinguished mark and worshipped it with many and various kinds of distinguished offerings. From that time forward, the worship of the mark arose in this world.

The Great God is one who gives pleasure. He is called "one possessed of desire" because this mode of desirous behavior is present in him — that is, he engaged in desire with the daughters of the sages. Or alternatively, desire means the attachment of desire, and one who possesses that is called one possessed of desire. The mark refers to the male organ. "Of the sages" refers to those who dwell in the thaṅśing grove. As for that through which the curse was made: "May your mark fall, may your mark fall" — these are harsh words roused by anger throughout. Falling means having collapsed to the ground.

Now, you, the Blessed One, the buddha — you have caused desire itself to fall. That is, you have abandoned the very attachment of desire along with all its habitual tendencies. What kind of desire? It is described as "the root of the mass of affliction." The root of that mass of affliction in this life and in other lives is desire itself. The Blessed One has also stated this at length in a sūtra, saying: "Through the cause of attachment, through the basis of attachment, through the power of attachment, mother and son speak together intimately, and the son too acts intimately with the mother." The master Āśvaghoṣa also stated:

Bound by desire, the world is slain and inflated,
exhausted, terrified, and overtaken by manifold sufferings.
Through the very pursuit of desired aims, kings fall,
and, having destroyed the Dharma, they go elsewhere to the hells.

As for the phrase "born of the island, and so forth": "born of the island" refers to the sage Vyāsa. The expression "and so forth" includes the sage Vālmīki,

the author of the Rāmāyaṇa tale, and also other poets and their respective compositions. The phrase "for the most part" means in great number. This indicates that there is some small amount among them that has been well examined and discerned by reasoning from one's own standpoint. "What others have said" refers to the explanations of those on the other side — they speak those things, and worldly people delight in them. This states the following: what those such as Vyāsa and so forth have said regarding the Bhārata and so forth is for the most part a repetition of what others have said before them.

As for the verse "You, by means of Dharmas not held in common," and so forth: "not held in common" means that which has not been stated by others. "Dharmas" refers to the scriptures, in particular the excellent ones, which fully illuminate the Four Noble Truths.

The phrase "having understood it within his own mind" means that he himself realized it without relying on instruction from others. As it is extensively stated in the Sūtra of Turning the Wheel of Dharma: "Monks, with regard to phenomena never heard before, the thought, knowledge, and discernment arose in me: this is the Noble Truth of suffering," and so forth.

The phrase "and taught" means that he caused others to learn it. This is as it is said: "All these synonyms of Dharma, the wandering practitioners and others, are to be taught" — and so on as stated there.

Regarding the phrase "of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)," and what follows: "of the non-Buddhists" means belonging to the tīrthikas. What are these? The words of the Vedas — the other words belonging to the tīrthikas. "In seclusion" means in a place without people. "Exclusively" means with certainty — how so? They speak and teach those things, and they alone do so. Or alternatively, the brahmins say this: "The Vedas are in no way to be allowed to be recited by one who is not a brahmin." And just as the Jain ascetics do not give the treatises of the Jain star-lore to those who are not naked ascetics, and just as treatises such as the Fifth Night of the Vaiṣṇavas and so forth are not to be spoken to others — so they say: "In secluded places, these are to be spoken only to those individuals who are of a certain definite mind."

Regarding the phrase "You, by means of" and what follows: this is like the roar of a lion, and so it is the lion's roar. This is what it teaches: you, by roaring with the lion's roar, teach all śramaṇas, brahmins, practitioners, and wanderers, being free from miserliness and free from partiality.

Regarding the phrase "the Sāṃkhyas," and what follows: the truth of reality according to the Sāṃkhyas is explained thus: "When this person enters into this — the intrinsic nature possessed of the quality of vitality, and possessing the forms of dust and darkness — the yogin who, having become entirely solitary, sees the twenty-five realities, is at that point liberated." So they say.

"Bhāradvāja" means that he is the son of the sage Bhāradvā, and so he is called Bhāradvāja. "Though he had realized that very suchness" means that he had seen the reality as explained by the Sāṃkhyas. And this is how it came to pass, as I have heard: that Bhāradvāja, being devoted to fierce ascetic conduct and knowing suchness through Sāṃkhya knowledge, dwelt in the forest. The gods dwelling in that forest saw him and thought: "If this person continues practicing such austerities, he will be capable of becoming an obstacle to us. So let us ruin his austerities." Thereupon a divine maiden named Vasantī sent silk fabric dancing in the air, danced near his dwelling place, and began to sing. The sage, upon hearing this, emerged from his leafy bower, and the very sight of that divine maiden stirred his desire so violently that his mind was tormented and afflicted. He took her and entered the leafy bower, and for a very long time thereafter indulged in and experienced the pleasures of sensual enjoyment with her. Thus the meaning is: Bhāradvāja was thoroughly attached to and infatuated with the divine maiden named Vasantī.

The phrase "master, you" is a form of address, meaning: you who have become sovereign over all Dharmas. The meaning is: even your disciples are free from attachment to women — what need is there to speak of you yourself? And so too, one who knows the nature of the things of saṃsāra will never develop attachment to the five qualities of sensory pleasure, which are ever perishing and utterly unworthy of trust.

Regarding the passage beginning "by the owl," the owl is explained by the authors of the Vaiśeṣika treatises as a particular kind of flesh-eater, and so forth. The phrase "to one who is distinguished" means: to a brahmin and others endowed with qualities, but not to others. As it is said:

Equal to one who is not a brahmin,
Twice that for an ordinary brahmin,
A hundredfold for one who recites,
And boundless for one who has crossed to the far shore of the Vedas.

Therefore, a donor who desires a distinguished result should give to a brahmin who has perfected the Vedas, and not to others who are not brahmins — and,

it is said, not even to one who has not completed mastery of all the Vedas, even if he is such a brahmin.

Regarding the passage beginning "you, O Protector," it is said: O Protector, O you who have become a refuge — you should give even to a dog. A question arises: this dog is not a distinguished field of merit, so why is it said that one should give to it? For this reason the text says "with compassion," meaning that great beings should engage in giving with compassion, not out of attachment to the growth of fruits and results. As the elder Triratnadāsa has said:

One who, upon seeing a wretched and destitute person
Full of hope and expectation,
Without affection seeks another vessel endowed with qualities,
Desiring fruit — though such a one gives, he is equal to a beggar.
Therefore, you who give with compassion to the poor —
Enter gladly into giving toward those who ask.

Therefore, your engagement in giving is carried out with great compassion and reverence toward those who beseech you.

Regarding the passage beginning "the austerity of the body," this means: the scorching torment of afflictions. The phrase "the knot it has made" means bondage — that is to say, affliction. "Dissolving it" means shattering and thoroughly abandoning it. When asked: who is it that, while still in the body, desires to dissolve the knot? — the text states: "naked ascetic," meaning a cloth-less ascetic who goes naked. Their philosophical conclusion is this: karma performed in former lives is exhausted through austerity; in this life, no new virtuous or non-virtuous karma is to be accumulated. As the karma abiding in the continuum of the body is exhausted, rebirth is exhausted; as rebirth is exhausted, suffering is exhausted; and through the exhaustion of suffering, nirvāṇa is attained. Such is their position.

Regarding the passage beginning "you indeed," because it is of the mind, it is "mental" — or rather, this is of the mind, and so it is mental austerity. The meaning expressed is: it is through mental austerity alone that you dissolve the knot, exhaust karma, and exhaust afflictions — not through bodily austerity. As the master Aśvaghoṣa has said:

One who is afflicted desires childish, foolish people;
One is attached to the appearances of the objects of the senses.
Seeing that both of these are flawed,

I recognize the path of the nectar of immortality.

Therefore this reasoning is sound: because the mind is the ground of all afflictions, it is the mind alone that effects all harm; and therefore the mind itself must be thoroughly purified so that it does not become the support of afflictions in the future. When there is no ground, afflictions do not arise; without afflictions, actions do not come forth; and without those, rebirth is not taken up.

The absence of that is liberation — this is what the Blessed One has well taught. Bodily austerities are pointless, because the mind is the sovereign, and one turns away from doing what ought not be done by means of that sovereignty, not through the body.

Regarding the passage "logicians, concerning things" and so forth: the logicians here are the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). "Things" refers to self, intrinsic nature, time, direction, and so on — entities that do not exist, yet which they assert as truly subsisting and take up as objects of inquiry. "Without scrutiny" means: without analysis or investigation.

Those logicians spoke in this manner:

One should not undertake investigation
through reasoning that is contrary to the Dharma.
If one becomes like the blind and the mute,
then whatever is taught, examine it with that.

Alternatively, whoever is supremely inclined toward treatises of corrupt reasoning is a logician. Such a person, having accepted a system whose terms are inverted and whose arguments lead to a plurality of extremes, tries to prove non-existent things as if they existed. They reason thus: the cause of milk is the heavy substance in a cow, and because milk arises from that cause, milk resembles it. Now the cause of that cow's heavy substance is the cow itself — for the heavy substance in milk arises from that cause; therefore a cow's heavy substance is also a cause of milk. Whatever does not function as a cause of milk does not arise from its cause — like a stone, for instance.

Here, unintelligent people, even having accepted that a cow's heavy substance cannot itself be the cause of milk, will delight in making such an assertion. But one who possesses wisdom will understand it to be characterized by a multiplicity of extremes — grease, hair, urine, and so forth.

Again, they assert that the self exists, pointing to its functions as evidence, comparing it to fire. They say: whatever has observable functions exists — just as fire, for instance, has observable functions such as cooking; and where there is no fire, those functions are not observable, like a rabbit's horn. The functions of the self, they claim, are being an agent, an experiencer, a goer, a teacher, and so on. But those who possess wisdom hold that the body which would serve as its support is not established, and therefore the very cause of the self is absent — and there are many faults in that position, which should be elaborated at length.

Regarding "you, master of words" and so forth: "you, master of words" is an address to a fool. "Master of words" means "lord of speech." "Not examining anything whatsoever, yet claiming it was well taught" means: whatever was spoken without analysis or investigation, without the support of reasoning — none of that constitutes something well taught. And in this regard, the Blessed One taught, from the suffering of birth and the suffering of old age onward to "in brief, the five appropriated aggregates (skandhas) are suffering" — all of it is precisely of that nature.

Furthermore, the lines:

Taking up ethical discipline brings happiness,
giving brings joy,
and loving-kindness is the antidote to aversion —

all of that is entirely correct and singularly true; this should be elaborated at length.

Regarding "the lychee" and so forth: the lychee is the fruit of a full-grown tree. From what path? It says "having pierced the solar disk" — having bored through and hollowed the orb of the sun. People of the world say that liberation proceeds through the center of the solar disk. Regarding "liberation": buddhas hold that liberation is the absence of aggregates, for the aggregates are suffering.

The absence of those aggregates is liberation. And this is how it is: all five aggregates are endowed with all three forms of suffering, and so they remain in suffering against one's own wishes. There is nothing whatsoever in them that is pleasant or desirable. Consider, for example, a heap of filth: because even a great heap of filth is itself filth, people find it disagreeable — and in the same way, whether a middle quantity or a small amount or even the most minute particle, it is equally disagreeable. Gods and humans alike hold that

the entirety of all such things is to be regarded as unwanted. As it is said: "The pure is that which gods and humans praise." Thus even the aggregates at the very peak of existence, being endowed moment by moment with conditioning factors, are rendered unwanted, and noble ones regard them as nothing but suffering — so what need is there even to mention the hells at the lower end? Therefore, the absence of these aggregates, which have become suffering, is the supreme happiness. And that, it is said, is liberation.

Among the non-Buddhists, some explain it thus: through the power of gnosis, karma and mental afflictions are exhausted, and thereby a person is no longer tormented by body and faculties and the like, and is freed from whatever obstacles and residues remain — that, they say, is liberation. Others say: the perfection of all the pleasures and enjoyments of sensory happiness, combined with the excellence of a state achieved through continuous cultivation of the distinction of consciousness — that is liberation.

So then, what is held here to be liberation? Previously there was no realization; the word "realization" is now employed in proximity to indicate that later one arrives at a liberation that is understood with certainty. And that, it is said, is obtained by Netsō having bored through the solar disk. This is to be understood as follows, as has been heard: Just as the one called Netsō, son of the great sage Gyaspa, looked upon beings tormented by a hundred miseries, and great weariness arose in him, and he wished to go to the city of nirvāṇa, the utterly fearless — and by receiving the instructions of King Kyepa, he obtained miraculous powers, soared into the sky, bored through the center of the solar disk by the force of his miraculous powers, and entered the city of liberation — so it is said.

Furthermore: "You have passed beyond sorrow; true liberation is already yours, yet you have gone nowhere at all." This means that the Blessed One does not go anywhere at all. And as it is said: "As a lamp that has gone out — such a mind is utterly free." Thus, wherever the yogin practices, that very place is where the five aggregates pass beyond sorrow, and they do not arise again.

On this point the master Aśvaghoṣa said:

Just as when a lamp has gone out
it goes neither downward nor upward,
and does not go in any direction or intermediate direction —
it simply ceases, the oil exhausted.

So too the Sage passed into nirvāṇa —
he does not go to the earth, does not go to light,
is not in any direction or intermediate direction —
he simply comes to peace, the afflictions exhausted.

Regarding the passage "Liberation — another who produces transformation," and so forth: the one called King Kyepa, dwelling in great austerity, obtained mastery of the path of yoga, and in due time, passing beyond the body, went to nirvāṇa. And his disciple Netsö, it is said, bored through the center of the solar disk with his own body and reached liberation by a different path.

Regarding the passage "By whatever path you yourself," and so forth: the meaning is that the Blessed One, the Buddha, obtained liberation by departing along the path of liberation — and that his disciples, Śāriputra and the others, attained liberation by going along that very same path.

Regarding the passage "Viṣṇu (Nārāyaṇa) took the women," and so forth: Viṣṇu is Nārāyaṇa. "Sixty thousand women" means that many women in number. "Took hold" means he served them with honor and placed them in his care. "Came about" means it occurred. The saying here is spoken in the context of the verse "The old man was pierced by Viṣṇu's arrow."

"The Teacher" means one who teaches and instructs — the meaning is that he truly reveals and shows the path. The meaning of "transcendent over the world" is: having become the most excellent among beings of the world, he has surpassed the world — he has become the foremost of the world. This is just as the Blessed One declared: "Among sentient beings with no feet, with many feet, with form, or without form, the Tathāgata is supreme." "Without self" means having become devoid of any such aspect — that is to say, without self. Through this, the text shows that one is free from afflictions by way of having abandoned the view of the transitory collection.

"Without appropriation" means being without the appropriation that belongs to connection with queens and the like, or connection with possessions. That is called "without appropriation." Through this, the text shows the abandonment of the very substance of the afflictions. And it is so called because there is no appropriation of the substance of the afflictions.

Regarding the passage "For Kāśī-Sumanā," and so forth: this is what was heard in the tradition. Not long after the great battle of Bharata had passed, a man impoverished by his kinsmen's ruin, his mind cast down with grief, wandering about, came to Vārāṇasī. In the main street he saw a courtesan of high rank

named Kāśi-Sumanā standing near a doorway, surrounded by a great crowd of people. With a mind drawn to the spectacle of it, he went toward her and asked: "Whose house is this?" Hearing of her qualities of form and so forth, he stood there with his mind stolen away.

Then a certain go-between said to Kāśi-Sumanā: "There is a certain brahmin ascetic standing at the door." And since she feared his curse, she went before him with offerings, washing of feet, and other acts of honor, welcomed him herself, led him inside, had him seated in a secluded place, and washed his feet with her own hands.

When Vyāsa had finished speaking with her, he took this as a sign, understood that the opportunity had come, and with great delight said: "Why do you smile without cause?" She replied: "You are said to be skilled in all the arts, yet you do not know how to massage hands and feet." He said: "If you are skilled in this, then extend your hand and show me." And she gave him her hand.

Then, just as one desirous of something might experience contact with many distinguished persons, the contact he felt was such as he had never previously experienced. And with that he became utterly attached, filled with longing for her company, wishing to spend an exceedingly long time with her, and desire and attachment arose in him. To whom was he attached? To Kāśi-Sumanā, the foremost of courtesans.

"Transformed" means: having subsequently experienced that desire for an exceedingly long time, he underwent a thorough transformation. "Even if you remain a householder" means even without having gone forth into renunciation. "Ignoble and despised" means not being a noble one and having become an object of contempt. "The faculties of sense objects" means the five domains of eye and so forth — that is, by means of the five qualities of desire.

"Not bewildered" means: not having undergone a transformation.

Regarding the line "Grown great, tormented by desire, distracted and dissolute" and what follows: because he was tormented and oppressed by desire, it is called "tormented by desire" — meaning pierced and afflicted by the attachment of longing. "Distracted and dissolute" means having become shameless through being unstable and mentally agitated.

"Trampled by the heels of a woman" means: trampled and struck by her two feet. Who is this woman? It is Grown-Great. And this is how it came about: the sage Grown-Great was dwelling together with Kāśi-Sumanā, experiencing the

pleasures of desire at his leisure. Then at a certain time, when the king of the city of Vārāṇasī, Brahmādatta, faced the threat of an enemy attack, he issued a command that even the young men should each dig ten trenches per day — let alone anyone else. Accordingly, Kāśī-Sumanā too was given this command. She searched with great wages for a hired man but could not find one, and fell into anxious thought. Grown-Great said to her: "Why are you unhappy? Give me a shovel and a pick, and I will dig the trenches." Having said this, he dug as much as he could, but the sun set before the trenches were finished. Then Grown-Great thought that the time of evening had come, and without going home he stayed right there. When, by the signs of the water-clock and other such marks, the day was fully complete and he knew that the time of night had arrived, while the minds of the king, his ministers, and the townspeople were distracted, and while they were intent on going in that direction, another brahmin happened to see Grown-Great with a mind distracted toward digging the trenches, and after a long while recognized him. Having heard of this from that brahmin, the king, his ministers, and the townspeople all went to him. They fell at his two feet and begged his pardon, but he turned his face away and remained there digging. He was frightened by a curse, and knowing that this was the lot assigned to Kāśī-Sumanā, he sent word to her: "This extraordinary capable sage has been commanded to dig trenches for your allotment — release him!" She sent a maidservant messenger three times, but he had no wish to rise. Then she herself mounted her conveyance and came, dismounted, and with her foot — adorned with an anklet — she trampled his head, saying: "Because I have been caused distress, I sent word three times — why did you not rise?" Grown-Great was pleased and said: "Because she showed such deep affection, I am indeed very fond of her" — and so he rose.

Again, the line "even if you remain a householder" means that even if you were surrounded and attended by a retinue of sixty thousand queens, there would be no turning away and no disturbance — that is to say, if there is not even the slightest stirring of mind toward one's queen, then how much more so in such a circumstance as this? It is shown to be utterly impossible.

Regarding the line "Ear-adorned, hard to overcome" and what follows: there was a king named Kuntibhoja, and he had a daughter named Kuntī, who was endowed with beauty, youth, and every excellence. At a certain point, the sage named Vile-Abode entered his home and prepared a milk-porridge. He quickly finished it, took the vessel filled with milk-porridge in his hand,

though experiencing great pain in his hands, without any change in his expression or complexion, he caused her to partake of the food with reverence. At the end of the meal, seeing that both lotus-hands had not been burned, he was thoroughly pleased and said: "Ask a boon of me. If you are willing, I shall give you such a boon that any man you desire shall come under your power." He then gave her a vidyā-mantra, saying: "If you recite this mantra, up to five times it will accomplish for you the siddhi of whomever you visibly desire." Having said this, he departed.

She sat there in the house, and a thought arose in her mind: "Is the meaning of this knowledge-mantra true, or is it not?" Wishing to test it, she recited it and prayed to meet with the sun. At that very instant, the sun appeared before her, riding in a chariot, clad in armor. Seeing him, she sought to turn him away, saying: "Do not come near me." But the sun said: "Having been invoked by prayer, I will not turn back without having done what is to be done. Otherwise I shall curse your entire lineage to utter ruin." She said: "How could one bring ruin upon one's own lineage?" Then, having once more bestowed upon her the gift of youth, the sun enjoyed with her the pleasures of desire, and departed. Immediately after that, she who was armored and ear-adorned gave birth to a son whose two ears were adorned with earrings. Then a companion of hers filled his mouth with honey and butter, wrapped his body in the softest cloth, placed him in a box, and taking the box, went by night to the bank of the Gaṅgā, and said:

"This beautiful son of the sun —
let the ocean guard the box.
Let the assembled host of gods
and Brahmā too protect him always."

Having said this, she cast him into the Gaṅgā. Not far from the Gaṅgā there was a charioteer of the king of Aṅga, named "Horse of Excellence with the Eye of a Protector of the Kingdom," who was tending horses. He saw the box being carried along by the river Gaṅgā, and ordered his attendants to retrieve it and bring it to him. Seeing the child, he thought: "This shall be my son," and raised him.

At that time there was one called Delight-in-the-Mountains, Weapon-Tipped (a name meaning he was skilled in the art of weapons), who was practicing austerities, and he had made this vow: "I will not teach this art of weaponry to those who are not brahmins." The ear-adorned one, however, dressed himself

in brahmin garb and went to him, and learned the brahmin's art of weaponry. That teacher taught him everything. Having well learned the art of weaponry, he went into battle, offered himself as an ally, and was given the kingdom of Aṅga, becoming the king of Aṅga. And so the story continues at greater length. Then Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) thought: "The time of battle is now approaching, and this ear-adorned one will make war against Arjuna (Śṛeḍa)." And so Śakra dressed in brahmin garb and went to the ear-adorned one. The ear-adorned one asked up to three times what purpose had brought him, and even when invited as a guest, was unwilling to speak plainly. Then at last, having been asked seven times what he desired, he said: "I desire your armor." And Śakra replied: "Why did you not speak before? I will give it to you without hesitation." Then taking a vajra-knife, the ear-adorned one cut the armor from his own body and gave it to him. Śakra, thoroughly pleased, said:

"There is none so giving as the Ear-Adorned One,
who, to fulfill the wish of a petitioner,
does not even spare his own life.

"There is none so loving as my equal."

Thus he spoke. There are many more such tales of these figures, but they have not been elaborated here. The story of how Conflict came to be is told as follows. Aṅgabhadra, Viśvavīrya, Bhīmakara, and Vipula — these four are brothers, born of the Gaṅgā. Aṅgabhadra was slain in battle by a gandharva king named Aṅgabhadra, on account of a grudge over a name. Viśvavīrya died from having been afflicted by a great plague. Bhīmakara entered into the holy life of celibacy, and the one called Sukhavān said to Bhīmakara: "Our line is going to die out, so make an effort to beget a son." He replied: "Although we are brothers, I have practiced celibacy from youth and will not experience the pleasures of desire." Having refused in this way, all the relatives of that family gathered together and made petition to Vipula, whereupon, in due sequence from Vipula's union, Ambikā, Ambālikā, and one called Vikalpinī were born — three daughters — from whom, in turn, three sons were born: Viśvakṣema, Śyāmaśeṇa, and one called Sudhī. Viśvakṣema became blind, while Śyāmaśeṇa conquered the entire great earth and gave it to Viśvakṣema. And Vipula, as his finest gift to Viśvakṣema, said: "From your noble gandharva wife may a hundred sons be born, and from among them shall there arise an elder brother named Conflict."

In time it came to pass that the gandharva woman became pregnant, and after three years a lump of flesh like an iron hammer was born. Vipula then said: "Cut this lump of flesh into a hundred pieces, place each piece separately, and sprinkle them repeatedly with cold water." Then in time a hundred sons were born from these, all with complete faculties, whereupon Sudhī said to Viśvakṣema: "This one called Conflict possesses the marks of evil, and therefore, by reason of him, all the lineages of the low-born will come to ruin. You should know this, and he must be slain by every means. In slaying one son and thereby preserving the lives of many living beings, I see no fault whatsoever. In the treatises on Dharma it is said:

The great evil whose fruit will be small —
that one must never commit;
but the small wrongdoing that yields great benefit —
the one of discernment must always perform.

Thus having spoken, yet out of love for his son he was unable to slay him. Śyāmaśeṇa went to the forest to practice austerities. Sudhī was one with a mind turned toward Dharma; and when Viśvakṣema became without power, Conflict was made king.

Then between the Ear-Adorned One and Conflict, an extensive account of their battle is given. At that time, when Sidhyasiddhi made petition, Viṣṇu became the charioteer and led them onto the field of battle. Being there, Sidhyasiddhi looked out over the entire assembled army and spoke thus. And speaking in this way, he did not go to battle:

"When Kunti's son looked out upon them all,
each was arrayed before him as a kinsman.
Overwhelmed by the most tender loving-kindness,
he was overcome with dejection and spoke these words:

O Viṣṇu, seeing these kinsmen,
abiding here with desire to fight,
my body shrinks and fails,
my mouth becomes completely dry;
my body trembles,
and every hair stands on end;
the bow falls from my hand,
and my skin burns all over;
my mind whirls in confusion

and I cannot hold my ground.
Those very ones for whose sake
kingdom, pleasures, and happiness were desired —
they themselves, abandoning life and wealth,
stand ready to do battle with me."

And speaking thus and so forth, he would not fight.

When Viṣṇu saw that he had thus become bereft of enthusiasm, he spoke to rouse enthusiasm in him for the purpose of slaying the low-born ones:

"Born of a water jar — the victorious chariot of Bhīmakara, the Ear-Adorned One —

"Just so, I have slain other heroes of the world.
Do not be displeased in your mind — slay them!
In battle you shall surely become the victor over your enemies.
Know furthermore that whoever shall conquer all of this
is imperishable and indestructible.
That which is imperishable and inexhaustible
cannot be slain by anyone.
This body will have its end,
yet the embodied ones are said to be eternal.
Since it is subject to destruction yet has become immeasurable,
fight, O Bharata!"

"For example, just as a person discards old garments
and takes up new ones elsewhere,
so too, having cast off the old body,
the embodied one takes up other new bodies."

Having spoken these and other such words, Arjuna followed them and, joining battle, he slew hundreds of thousands upon countless thousands of living creatures.

Now, regarding the phrase "for the sake of sentient beings" and so forth: "sentient beings" means living creatures. "Wishing to benefit them" means wishing to actually bring about their benefit. And having wished thus, what did he do? As it says: "You too gave up your very life." Here one should apply the birth-story of the Lotus-Bearer and others as an illustration.

Regarding the passage "Viṣṇu acted through trickery" and so forth: "trickery" is a form of deception. Having acted through trickery, what did he do? The text then mentions "three strides" and so forth. This is to be understood as follows. Viṣṇu transformed the entire expanse of the earth into the form of a dwarf and, by three paces, took it away from the powerful one. That land was then given back many times over, discarded like your own grass. As for the question of what kind of person you are, the text says "one who desires liberation," meaning one who definitely desires to attain liberation. Here one should apply as illustration the sūtra of the Great Delight-Giver and others.

As for the account of Viṣṇu's act of trickery, it was already recounted in the earlier passage beginning "Viṣṇu, having transformed into the form of a dwarf."

Regarding "the arrow that brings joy and that takes life" and so forth: this is to be understood as follows. The Brahmin Jāmāda had an ascetic wife, and his son, called Joyful One, was exceedingly brave. Now at that time there arose a king called Siddhasiddha, who went to a place where herds of cattle were kept. The Brahmin Miśradatta, who was fond of fighting, went to confront him. When the sound of hail caused a cow belonging to Jāmāda to take fright, King Siddhasiddha asked about it, and Miśradatta replied that the cow was frightened by the bowstring drawn by Phoṅslobpa, the son of Jāmāda. Then Joyful One, who was born of the renunciant lineage, overcame his rival, and praise of his qualities was spoken. The king, enraged, resolved by all means to do battle with Joyful One, and pride arose in him. He went to the dwelling place and stole a calf. Then, while Joyful One was resting in meditative absorption, he threw a dead snake onto his body. Now the Dusty One had a gracious manner: when she bent down to a flower, the trees would bow of themselves. When the king saw her, he became captivated. From that point on the trees bowed no more. The Jāmādas, knowing this through the power of their meditative absorption, and being angry with his wife, said to Joyful One: "Cut off your mother's head!" And he, no sooner than he was commanded with his father's words, cut off her head. Then the father, being pleased, said: "My son, ask for the highest boon!"

He asked the highest boon that his mother be restored to life, and she was indeed revived. From that moment on, enraged by that very cause, Joyful One swore: "I shall leave not a single royal lineage in this world." Thereafter he took up arms against his enemies, joined battle with the protectors of kingdoms, and however many thousands of arms those enemies had, he cut

off every one of them and brought them down to the ground. Then he set out to destroy the royal lineages from their very roots, and he wiped out all the royal lineages in the world. This is the meaning of the line, "Having rid the world of its royal lineages." And by whose hand was this done? The verse names "the life-cutting arrow" — since it is the nature of the arrow to extinguish living beings and bring them to nothing, it is called "life-cutting," and it is his arrow that did so. "Having gained renown" means that fame and acquisition were obtained. "Joyful One" refers to Joyful One of the many-armed. "His" refers to the acts of Joyful One. "In your teaching" refers to the teaching of the blessed one, the Buddha. "Not renown" means having become a matter of ill-repute. And this is how it is to be understood: even the killing of a creature as small as an ant is, in your teaching, grounds for blame — how much more, then, need one say of the slaying of royal lineages? As for the line "Evil report and skya-bseng and so forth," "evil report" refers to being difficult to confront in battle and so forth, and "skya-bseng" refers to steadfastness at the battle-front and the like. "For whose sake one goes to battle" means: it is for the sake of the splendor of royal sovereignty that one engages in combat and fighting. And indeed, by fighting for the sake of gathering that royal splendor, all the living beings encompassed in the full count of the eighteen divisions of an army were brought under the power of death. "That splendor" refers to the flourishing of sovereignty over the earth — and he abandoned and utterly cast it aside. How did he abandon it? As the verse says, "Like a poisonous creeper-tree": just as someone who, out of fear, abandons a tree around which poisonous serpents are coiled and dwell, so too — wounded by the poison of the serpent of evil conduct, with the Blessed One knowing that a mere instant of rejoicing would but compound suffering — he utterly abandoned the splendor of that suffering-laden sovereignty and departed without attachment. As for the line "Having found your teaching," "your teaching" means: the teaching of you, our Protector — the scriptural collection that tames through the Dharma. "Having found it" means having examined it and come to know it. "In the forest of tāñ-trees" refers to a grove of tāñ-trees. In that place there is the one called the Great God, who is the Bringer of Bliss. "Yoga" here refers to the excellences of meditative concentration, and since he is master over these, he is called "the Lord of Yoga" — meaning the sages who have obtained various meditative concentrations. "The conduct of the Lord of Yoga" refers to the transformations of the body. "Taught" means pointed out. "Explained" means expounded. "Not knowing" is to be utterly confused, and since his conduct is a

mode of distorted transformation, it is called "conduct of one who does not know." And this is what is being taught: upon hearing what the Great God did to the sages who are Lords of Yoga dwelling in the tāṇ-tree grove, one understands that, when measured against the scriptural collection of your teaching, it is a completely deluded behavior, stupefied by utter ignorance.

The subject matter of this passage was written in the section entitled "The Great God (Śiva) and the Marks of One Who Has Desires," so it will not be written here again.

"Indra, the rat without restraint" — and so forth.

"Indra" refers to Śakra (Indra, king of the gods). "Without restraint" refers to the wife of the sage Gautama. "Brahmins still proclaim it" means that brahmins continue to revile him even now. Why? Because of "the rat" — that is, because he behaved in an improper manner. This is because in the Vedas, when Indra is invoked, the epithet "Gautamī's rat, without restraint" is recited.

Regarding "your" and so forth: moreover, it is Indra himself who proclaims and makes clear the fame of your virtues. What does he proclaim? "That the supreme fruit has been obtained." The expression "supreme fruit" is here taken to mean the fruit of stream-entry, for it is so designated in relation to all worldly fruits. That fruit, moreover, is obtained through the undefiled path and is itself immutable. This too should be compared with what is explained in the Abhidharma concerning "the fruit, or certainty, arises from what comes before," and with the sūtra cited here in which Indra makes his request.

Regarding "Viṣṇu, by the dark-dappled one" and so forth: in this world there arose two asuras — one called Kṛṣṇa-dappled and another called Kuntong, who was possessed of great power to crush opponents. Through the force of their mutual arrogance they fell into conflict with each other, each striving to be victorious over the three worlds. In this striving, Viṣṇu found the other's efforts intolerable and bent himself to devising a means of killing him. At one point, Viṣṇu took up his discus, went to Kṛṣṇa-dappled, and engaged him in battle. He was struck by the other's club and his body was wounded, so that Viṣṇu trembled and shrank back and began to flee. Finding no other refuge, he crept beneath the bed where Kuntong was sleeping. Kuntong came quickly and said, "Where have you gone? Come back out!" At this Kuntong was roused from sleep. Upon waking, he saw that Viṣṇu had come in, and from beneath the bed heard the pitiful cry, "Save me!" He thought: "He has surely come to kill me, and my attendant, in fear, has crept beneath this bed." Thinking this, he said:

"Who could bear such great contempt from another?" He seized a weapon, rose up, and the two of them fell into battle with each other, and both were killed.

Viṣṇu is the son of Brahmā. Kṛṣṇa-dappled is an asura; the expression "troubled and terrified by the dappled one" means frightened by Kṛṣṇa-dappled. "Becoming bewildered" means that his mind was thrown into turmoil. "He crept beneath Kuntong's bed" means that, out of fear, he crept beneath the bed of the asura Kuntong.

"Lord, you" is a form of address, meaning "the one called the Sovereign." "Without any fear" — that which is without dread and fear is called "without fear." Fearless of whom? The word "entirely" is used, meaning that the Tathāgata has been declared to be one who has passed beyond all fears.

Regarding "the Lord of beings, he himself" and so forth: having heard this, in that intermediate aeon there arose a lord of beings called Myurwa. At one point, a girl named Trulzhug Zangmo, who through the qualities of her form and so forth outshone all other divine maidens and dwelt surpassing them,

Because of this, the lord of beings called Myurwa developed a mind of astonishment that she could draw forth all the worlds, thinking, "I myself am unable to produce and bring forth anything like this." He then took her and kept her close until they arrived together in the world of Brahmā.

Now, at a certain moment, Brahmā, the Great God (Śiva), Dharma who also was present there in bodily form, and the others had all gathered together in one place, when Myurwa said, "Look at this one — my daughter Palmo, who surpasses even them in splendor," and he sat right there. Whereupon Brahmā was seized by desire and, unable to govern his own mind, he entered into illicit union with her. In the same way, the Great God, Dharma, and the lord of beings Myurwa also entered into illicit conduct with her. Immediately after this, four sons together with their colors were born simultaneously.

Then Brahmā declared, "All of them are my sons." The Great God and the others said the same. Because of this dispute, a tumultuous clamor arose from the world of Brahmā and spread throughout the world. Hearing this commotion, the gods headed by Śakra (Indra) came to settle the quarrel and declared in verse:

A son in this world, for the most part,
resembles his father in likeness.

Therefore whichever one he resembles in form,
to that one he belongs.

After this, each took his own son in accordance with the resemblance in form.

Now the commentary explains: "The lord of beings" refers to Myurwa. "Himself" means by his own act. "The girl" means his own daughter. "Lay together" means to engage in sensual conduct — that is, to experience the pleasure of desire together with her. "Heard" means having heard that account. "You, O Sage" is a form of address. "Even the disciples" means also with respect to the śrāvakas, and from the particle "even," one should understand that there is no need even to speak of a buddha, the Blessed One. "The holy life is without fault" — the holy life (brahmacarya) here means the restraint of the sense faculties and the restraint of ethical conduct. "Without fault" means that this holy life is untainted by any turbid defilement; that is what "without fault" signifies.

Regarding "the brahmins" and what follows: "giving and receiving" means giving and receiving — since both occur together, it is called "giving and receiving." What is it that is said to transfer? It is stated: "virtue and non-virtue." Virtue means merit — acting well. Non-virtue means demerit — acting wrongly. The transferring of these virtuous and non-virtuous acts is what is called "transference." Who says this? It is stated: "the brahmins" — meaning the sages (ṛṣis). And their reasoning is as follows: just as it is fitting to give gold, grain, food, drink, and so on to others, and to receive them from others, so too merit and non-virtue are said to be the same. For the brahmins say: "The non-virtuous acts such as killing a brahmin and so forth can be transferred from others to oneself at will, and merit likewise is the same" — this is their established doctrine.

Regarding "you" and what follows: if that were so, then what one has done would become wasted and lost. It would follow that although one performed virtuous or non-virtuous acts, their karmic maturation would perish without ripening for oneself, because the ripening would instead be given to others. And it would follow that one would encounter results from acts one had not personally done, because one would be experiencing the pleasant and unpleasant fruits of acts done by others. Therefore these views are unreasonable — for if what one has done could be experienced by another, then

why would a son become satiated merely because his father has eaten food? If the understanding realized by one person could arise in another, then how could it fail to be the case that by hearing a treatise once one would grasp and know all treatises? If transmigration exists, why should it be precisely the understanding itself that transmigrates?

One does not perform virtue for the sake of others to teach,
for what another has done, this one does not follow after.
What one has obtained for oneself does not waste what has been done,
and a result from what was not done does not exist.

What was not done is never something done;
from what was not done, happiness does not arise elsewhere.
There is no going to that fortunate state —
therefore strive in the performance of virtuous deeds.

This has been taught thus.

Regarding "the defining characteristic of the self according to the Kapila-school" and what follows: the defining characteristic of the self means the defining characteristic of the person. "Endowed with knowledge" means endowed with understanding — the one thoroughly conceived as being of the essential nature of consciousness is understood to be a person whose own essential nature is that of being endowed with cognition. In the first age, there appeared a sage called the Kapila-school founder, who composed the treatises of the Sāṃkhya (Skt. Sāṃkhya) system. His disciples are also called Kapila-followers, for they are sons of Kapila; thus the disciples too are called "sons." Now what the Kapila-followers have thoroughly conceived is their asserted position — and this text shows that it is nothing more than a mere conception without valid reasoning.

Regarding "you" and what follows: if that position is accepted, it would follow that the self is impermanent, unstable, and momentarily perishing — this is what you, the Protector, have taught. Now it is wrong for them to claim that the person is both endowed with mind and permanent. And this is because: first, through the faculty of the eye one cognizes form; at that very same time, the person also cognizes sound and so forth. If the knower were possessed of form and permanent, it would always exclusively cognize the object form, and thereby it would be like a deaf mute with respect to sound and the rest — yet nothing of the sort is observed in the world. Alternatively, if form were cognized through one faculty and sound and the rest were cognized through

other faculties at another time, then in that case, being one who is endowed with a distinctive and clear form of knowledge, it would follow that there would be the fault of transformation and so forth.

Here an objection is raised:

How can one speak of a person
as the permanent one who possesses all objects at once?
If it depends on various other causes,
how then can it be permanent?

Whatever has been cognized even to a slight degree —
all of that does not belong to a stable self.
If the self were impermanent, like a pot,
it would then become comparable to a rabbit's horn.

Whatever function a capacity performs —
that purpose exists as the highest purpose.
But if it were absent and became momentary,
it contradicts both gradual and non-gradual arising.

Such is the reasoning, and so forth.

"Kapila the great sage" means the great ṛṣi (Skt. ṛṣi). "The knower" means one whose essential nature is understanding — this is the quality belonging to the person that serves the purposes of others. Therefore the self here is something different from what the Sāṃkhya conceives as the person's own form in the mode of a knowing being, for it is not like that. "All-pervading" means pervading everything. The meaning of "to be fully declared" is: that this self is both other than and all-pervading relative to consciousnesses — this is the intended meaning of its full declaration.

And so the great sage Kapilaḥ, the author of the Vaiśeṣika (Skt. Vaiśeṣika) treatises, reasons thus in his own mind: if the self were of the nature of understanding, it would follow that it is impermanent; but the self must be accepted as permanent. Therefore, the self is not possessed of form in the mode of consciousness; rather, consciousness is that which is of the essential nature of understanding. It operates in proximity to an object and, bearing the image of that object, abides near the person.

Being all-pervading and permanent, there is no fault here whatsoever — so he says.

Regarding the passage beginning with "yours" and so forth: if that is so, then since it lacks understanding it would follow that it is like a piece of wood — this is the meaning of what is said. For if the self did not understand even the slightest thing, then grass and trees and the like also do not understand even the slightest thing; and if that is so, there would be no distinction whatsoever between grass, trees, and the like on the one hand, and this self on the other.

Here the objection is stated in verse:

If the self that does not understand
were like wood and grass and such, we do not accept it.
From the mere parity of not understanding,
how is one of them without mind?

If the very essence of the self is permanent,
what is the nature of that permanence?
How could it be reasonable that action and activity
should themselves be permanent?

Such faults as these would then be entailed
within this very system.

Therefore the wise do not accept
that this position is reasonable.

Regarding the passage beginning with "like the measure of the naked one's body" and so forth: "naked" refers to the adherents of the naked-ones' school (the Jainas). "Like the measure of the body" means that it is commensurate with the form of the body — the life-force is coextensive with the body, and is endowed with it. In a very small body it is very small; in a large body it is large. The life-force pervades the entire body, and the body abides as though it were a basket for it. Thus when the one contracts, the other contracts; when the one expands, the other expands. Contraction means being gathered together — the one in which the life-force resides — and what is distended is called life-force, vitality, and self — so they say. Life-force, birth, vitality, person, and individual are synonymous terms. "Asserts" means that this is what the teacher of the naked-ones' school asserts. The twenty-five teachers of the naked-ones' school — such as Ṛṣabha and Vardhamāna and the rest — teach and assert this.

Regarding the passage beginning with "you" and so forth: "you" refers to the Buddha, who has declared that life and vitality are destructible and impermanent. Why is that? Because of having a single side — so it is said. That

which has a single side is one-sided, meaning it has parts. What has no sides cannot be a substantial entity. Whatever has sides is impermanent by its very nature. Now, the body and the life-force are held to have a single side, and therefore this too is impermanent, like something with parts; and the body, which shares a single side with the life-force, is impermanent. Permanence combined with having parts is unreasonable and contradicts valid cognition.

The condensed verse on this point reads:

If it has a single side, how can it be permanent?

If it is permanent, it does not have a single side.

A substantial relation of the two kinds does not exist.

Therefore this system is not reasonable.

Regarding the passage beginning with "the brāhmaṇas hold the person to be the cause of all beings" and so forth: "brāhmaṇas" here means the scholars expert in the treatises of the enquirers, such as those in the tradition of Jaimini and the like. These hold the person to be the cause. The cause of what? It is said: the cause of all beings — meaning the entire world. This is established because the person present in the continuum of Devadatta is the cause of Devadatta himself, and not of Yajñadatta and the like. "Cause" here means the cause that produces or generates. What kind of cause? It is said: a permanent person. "Person" and "self" are not different in meaning. "Permanent" means unchanging. Although seeds and the like can also be causes, they are not permanent; and so by that specification a distinction is made. "Propounded" means firmly maintained.

Regarding the passage beginning "You have propounded" and so forth: if the person is permanent, it cannot be a cause; and if it is a cause, it cannot be permanent. "Permanent" and "cause" are mutually exclusive terms. The argument to be made here is this: whatever serves as a cause is impermanent — just as seeds and the like. Therefore, the person who is held to be the cause of all beings should be understood to be impermanent. Furthermore, there is no such thing as a permanent cause — just as, for example, space and the like have no causal efficacy. If what is permanent were itself to become a cause and then remain permanent, that would be a flat contradiction of valid cognition. Something that is unchanging and unaltering, that functions as a cause and yet is called permanent — nothing of that kind exists in the slightest. That is the meaning of your own statement that there is nothing of the kind.

Here it is said in verse:

If it is permanent, whose cause can it be?
If it does not perish, how can it be a cause?
"Permanent" and "cause" —
these two together make no rational sense.

Whatever is held to be permanent as a cause,
on that very account it is not permanent,
for its activity is there to be found
and cannot be discovered in every aspect.

If it should perform an action,
if at some other time it should not perform it —
in either case it follows without doubt
that it is impermanent.

Now, regarding the passage beginning "The great lord of a poisonous nature" and so forth: here is a story I have heard in accordance with this. There were two brothers among the asuras (demigods), named Windgain and Earthpossessor. Windgain was given the form of a dense body, and Earthpossessor was given a form in human dress. Together they invited the sages as guests. Windgain cooked the meal and, with great hospitality, served the food. When the sages had eaten, Earthpossessor went outside and called out, "Son Windgain, wherever you are, come here!" At that very instant, each and every thing that had been eaten burst out from the belly of those who had eaten it and came out. By this deed, the lineage of sages and the brahmin lineage was left with only a very small remnant. The performance of sacrificial offerings to the gods also came to nothing.

The gods then assembled and went to the abode of the great sage Āgata and petitioned him to slay those two asuras. Now, when those two had invited that sage as their guest, and he had eaten the food there, Earthpossessor called out, "Son Windgain, where have you gone?" — and the sage uttered a great roar and said, "I have already digested it." Then, enraged and agitated, he consumed Earthpossessor there and then, in plain sight. And so powerful was the torment of thirst that came over him that he drank whatever lakes and ponds and such bodies of water existed, yet could not be satisfied. He then went and drank the ocean.

At that time there was a king by the name of Poisonous. He had two wives. The first wife had a son named Unruly. The other wife, through a boon received

from the Great God (Śiva), came to have sixty thousand sons. Now, the king was about to undertake the horse sacrifice, so he took his vows, attached the horse to the sacrificial post as an offering implement, set up the fire altar, and all the rest. Then, in order to guard those horses, he arrayed all sixty thousand sons in armour with various weapons in hand and set them to keep watch.

Then Viṣṇu thought to himself: "If this entire ocean were to dry up, by what means could it be filled again? From this situation of the king called Poisonous who is about to perform the horse sacrifice, if I were to steal the horse, my purpose could be accomplished thereby." With that thought, he went and took the horse and entered underground.

When the sons of Poisonous heard this news, they drained the ocean and entered underground. From there, Viṣṇu, taking on the appearance and dress of a yellow-robed sage —

— they saw all the horses sitting there upon a lion throne. Thinking, "He has stolen them," they were seized by uncontrollable rage, and in their contempt for Viṣṇu they set about taking the horses. When Viṣṇu understood that the sons of Poisonous held him in contempt, he gazed upon them with eyes burning with fury, and reduced them all to ash. They died and were reborn in hell.

When Poisonous heard how things had gone, he sent a messenger to retrieve the horse. The messenger went, pleased Viṣṇu with praise and other offerings, and recovered the horse. He returned to his own city, and the king performed the rites of the horse sacrifice without interruption. When the king passed away, he was reborn in the realm of the gods.

After that, the messenger became a king. He had a son named Swift, whom he installed as ruler of the kingdom. Swift then heard how his uncles had been reborn in hell on account of that cause. He thought: "Neither Poisonous nor my father the messenger did anything to benefit them. I should accomplish what is needed for their sake." And so, with the aim of causing the Gaṅgā to descend, he practised austerities for thirty thousand divine years, yet he was unable to bring the Gaṅgā down. He passed away without accomplishing it.

Then his son Lipa likewise practised austerities for thirty thousand divine years in order to bring the Gaṅgā down, yet he too was unable. He also departed to another world.

Then his son Bhagoratha, through extraordinary austerities, pleased Brahmā, who granted him his supreme wish. Bhagoratha declared: "I will cause the Gaṅgā to descend to the human world in just this way." Brahmā then said to the Gaṅgā: "Flow down to the realm of human beings." At this, the Gaṅgā lamented greatly: "How shall I go there and become something common, to be resorted to even by those of low birth and the like? How is one to conduct oneself in such circumstances? It is also not right to transgress the word of one's forebear." Yet thinking, "Nevertheless I will go with great force and plunge directly underground," she was rebuked: "Would you descend underground without having first purified the human world?" And so the Great God (Śiva) received her within the mass of his matted locks. From there she emerged and flowed about for a thousand divine years, yet even as she flowed she could not find the edge of those locks.

Then once again Bhagoratha, by the excellence of his austerities, pleased the Great God, who wrung out his matted locks. A single drop fell upon the Himālayas and in one instant became a great lake. Even now it has become seven streams, as it is said:

The Sītā, Sindhu, and Vakṣu,
the Gaṅgā, ornament of the world likewise,
the Regal and the Satisfier,
and the Nalinī — these are said to be the seventh.

As the Gaṅgā intended to cross the great southern ocean, she bore herself arrogantly and carved through the Himālayas, then flowed smoothly through that gorge.

Now at that time there lived a sage named Jahnu who was a fierce ascetic. He was dwelling in that Himalayan gorge applying himself to the practice of yoga. When he saw the Gaṅgā flowing through with a loud rushing noise, swaying coquettishly in a leisurely course, he became extremely angry and went and said:

Here in this place so close to mine,
why does this woman walk without restraint
and with such wanton airs?
This is great misconduct and transgression.

Having said that, he took her up and drank her. Then Bhagoratha pleased that sage with austerities, and he spat her out. From there she flowed in all four directions without obstruction, filling the underground realm. She washed

away the remaining traces of the bond with the sons of Poisonous, and by that act, they too, it is said, were transferred from hell and reborn in the higher realms.

Thus it is applied to the expression "sixty thousand sons of the Poisonous one were burned." The phrase "the Great Sovereign" means that, because greatness of selfhood exists, he is called the Great Sovereign — one endowed with qualities such as extraordinarily vast enjoyment and so forth. Who is this? It is the one called Poisonous — the king called Ocean is the one called Poisonous. Who are those referred to? "The sixty thousand sons" — his sons, sixty thousand in number. By whom? By the one called Tawny-yellow, meaning Viṣṇu abiding in the form of the tawny-yellow. How? "By a mere glance" — it is taught that this was by his two eyes blazing with wrath. What did he do? "Burned" means he reduced them to ash.

"And to those" refers to the sixty thousand sons of Ocean. Alternatively, "to that" refers to the one who brought about their separation from life. "You acted with compassion" means that he arose in mind to do what was needful for them. And this is so because the Tathāgata never departs from the continuum of great compassion itself. As it is said, some who compose hymns of praise declare:

Compassion dwells in your heart, and perfect peace abides within your gaze.
Not even for an instant of patience can we bear to be parted from you.
Your surpassing beauty has long enraptured the mind.
And yet you are celebrated and renowned as one who is free of attachment.

"By that very tawny-yellow one" and so on — this is the statement of the sage Tawny-born, declaring that all will be born free of the Primal Sovereign without remainder.

Hear it as follows. In the first aeon, when the lifespan of living beings was immeasurable, there appeared a brahmin called Tawny-yellow. He dwelt in a hermitage, and through the distinction of his ascetic practice he attained liberation alone. In order to show the path correctly to others, he composed treatises. He taught two fundamental principles of primary substance, as follows: the Primal Sovereign and the Person.

Of these, the Primal Sovereign has three qualities: it acts through the forms of vitality, energy, and darkness; it undergoes transformation; and it is without mind. The Person, by contrast, is conscious, is an experiencer, and is permanent and co-equal.

How is the Primal Sovereign said to be the agent? The state in which the three qualities of vitality, energy, and darkness are balanced, possessing limbs and what has limbs — that is the Primal Sovereign. And when any one of the three becomes slightly active while the others remain unmanifest, that is called the Great One. From that arises something slightly coarser, called Pride, and from that transformation it changes further. From Pride there is transformation into eleven faculties: the five faculties of cognition — eye, ear, nose, tongue, and body — and the five faculties of action — hand, foot, speech, the organ of elimination, and the organ of generation — and mind. From the five subtle elements there is transformation into the five great elements: from the subtle element of sound comes space; from sound mixed with touch comes wind; from the first two mixed with form comes fire; from the first three mixed with taste comes water; from the first four mixed with smell comes earth. Reckoned thus, reality comes to twenty-four. The Person is the twenty-fifth.

When one does not know the distinction between "this is a quality" and "this is the Person," then the Person and the qualities become combined,

It is like the case of a man filled with desire who is together with a beautiful woman who delights in him, in a room pervaded by the darkness of night. But when he knows the distinction — knowing himself as the one who is different from the qualities, and as the one who undergoes change — then that Person will never again become intimate with her. It is like a man who, in the daytime and with eyes that can see, does not touch a beautiful woman. To see the Person and the qualities as distinct is the cause of attaining liberation — such is the established conclusion of the Sāṃkhya school.

Now, what kind of a renunciant says this? The verse says "by knowing suchness." Here, the word "suchness" is explained as referring to the twenty-five. By knowing these, one knows suchness; and "knowing suchness" means being wise.

Regarding the verse "your birth among beings," and what follows: afflictions and karma — these two, affliction and karma — are what birth arises from and is born of, and is therefore called that. This is because birth is what proceeds from afflictions. In this connection, the Elder Āśvaghoṣa declared:

When afflictions are exhausted, there is no bondage to existence.

When karma is exhausted, there is no suffering.

For whatever arises from what exists —

from what does not exist, that will not arise again.

As for what it is that arises from affliction and karma: the verse says "of beings." Because beings are possessed of death, they are called "beings" — the world of sentient beings. Their birth as arising from afflictions and karma is what you have proclaimed and declared.

Here it is said: without afflictions, beings have no wish to be born anywhere at all; without any karma whatsoever, neither pleasure nor suffering can arise. An arhat has no afflictions; without those, karma too is absent; and without karma, birth here does not occur — just as, when there is no seed, there can be no sprout. Thus it is stated, and so forth.

Regarding the verse "by renunciants such as the yellow-clad," and what follows: those who are of the nature of yellow-robed practitioners and the like hold that through liberation one continues to abide, and that one remains a cause of existence. According to them, the Person is permanent, and the body and sense faculties, having been compounded in the former life, will continue to act in the same way later. This is expressed in the verse:

The Person, though permanent,
endowed with a body and sense faculties,
later becoming one like that again —
there is no doubt this arises from conditions.

Regarding the verse "you," and what follows: the phrase "having passed into peace" means attaining the realm in which no remainder of the aggregates is left. The phrase "like a lamp gone out" means like a lamp that has died. "Beyond counting" means not entering into any enumeration.

Regarding the verse "certain tīrthikas," and what follows: "tīrthika" refers to the path of liberation and the path to higher states — a treatise that teaches these is called a "tīrtha" (ford), and one who makes or follows such a treatise is called a tīrthika. Such a one is possessed of liberation, that is, of going to nirvāṇa. "Going" means having gone; and one who possesses that going is "possessed of going," meaning: one who has attained it by going. The word "says" indicates that speech is involved; "saying" means stating. This was explained earlier in the passage where it was said: "It is heard that, having measured the sun with a shadow, such a one has declared liberation to be present." As for the verse line "that to which there is going — that is saṃsāra."

The phrase "that to which there is going — that is saṃsāra" means: the place to which going occurs — that is saṃsāra, that is cyclic existence. And precisely

because of this, through going one can never realize nirvāṇa. As the Blessed One also declared in a sūtra: "Raktaśva, I do not say that what is free from birth, free from death, and free from arising is attained by going." This is an example of what was said.

The line "Having known and understood, the Blessed One taught" means: the Blessed One, having understood and realized, then taught and explained — that is its meaning.

As for the line "the naked ones, pleasure-groves, and so forth": "the naked ones" refers to the naked ascetics (Jainas and similar renunciants). "This is everywhere delightful" — hence "pleasure-grove"; whatever takes the form of an ornamental garden and the like is called a pleasure-grove and so forth, meaning bathing-tanks and the like. "To establish" means to bring about through effort — that is its meaning. "Cause of demerit" means the cause of wicked conduct — that is its meaning. The reason is that these people, without any cause, accept demerit and assert and speak of it as a matter of doctrine.

And on this point there is a verse:

One who resides in a pleasure-grove
and is to be turned away from taking life —
if a living being should die there,
that one commits demerit and is implicated in the doing of it.
When a being possessed of mind dies there,
it becomes an occasion of great demerit.
Therefore those who wish to accumulate merit
should not act in that way.

And much more is said along these lines.

As for the phrase "omniscient one" and what follows: "omniscient one" is an appellation. "The same" refers to establishing the pleasure-grove and so forth. "Cause of merit" means accumulating merit in its proximity — that is the meaning. If one engages in an action one ought not to engage in, a great multitude of faults would follow from it.

When living beings on their journey are killed,
demerit will befall even you.
If you were without such a journey,
there would be no killing of living beings.
If there is such a journey and one is stained with demerit,

how could liberation itself come about?
How does that liberation come to be coupled with it?
Are you liberated by accumulating demerit?
Rather, those who abandon demerit entirely —
that alone is everywhere called liberation.
A mind that has not gone forward into demerit —
to say that demerit exists there is not well said.
When a teacher is satisfied and pleased
by the donation of food,
and the one who gave it dies without having been summoned —
demerit close at hand will arise.
One does not see action being performed
in solitude, free from attachment.
And furthermore, the Blessed One declared:
One who plants a pleasure-grove of forest trees,
who builds a bridge,
who gives a cistern, a rest-house, and a well,
and who provides a place of rest —
and likewise:
One who gives land for the sake of Śakra's (Indra's) temple,
generating the merit of Brahmā,
rejoices for an aeon in the heavenly realms.
— and more of this kind, as taught in the sūtras.

As for the line "from the body to other bodies" and what follows: "from the body" means from the affliction of aging and so forth that torments it. "To other bodies" means passing and going over into other bodies. What is it that does this? "The life-force" — which means the self, the person. What is that life-force like? "Subtle," it is said: supremely subtle, beyond the domain of the sense faculties. On this point, Viṣṇu said:

Just as a person discards old garments
and takes up fresh new ones,
so too, having abandoned an old body,
the embodied one takes up fresh new bodies.
This cannot be cut by weapons,

this cannot be burned by fire,
this cannot be made wet by water,
this cannot be dried up by wind.

— and so on, as it has been said.

The word "it is said" indicates that this is merely a worldly way of speaking; in the ultimate truth, in fact, there is no self.

If a self existed, it would become either permanent or impermanent, and so, when enjoying pleasure, it would enjoy it continuously, without falling into the faults of suffering and the like. Therefore the self does not exist in any respect whatsoever.

As for the phrase "of a changed body," here the word "body" refers to the five aggregates, which are spoken of as the thing that belongs to the self. The meaning joined to the phrase is this: you, the Blessed One, the Buddha, have declared that it is simply not the case that there exists a self, called a life-force, that is different from and distinct from that body. Moreover, the Blessed One declared that all phenomena are without a life-force, without a sustaining principle, and without a person — and so on, down to the statement: they are exhausted in nothing but a collection of formations. And yet, having conventionally posited the pride of self — insofar as the self there is merely imputed in dependence on what has become the thing of the five aggregates — the Blessed One has in certain contexts spoken of an entity that functions as a self.

Now, regarding "one who is slain in battle through anger" and what follows: "through anger" means: having become anger itself. As for "slain on the battlefield, in the place of combat," the fuller reading is: "such a person goes to a happy destiny." And it has been said in these words:

A divine maiden, adorned with varied ornaments,
will come and, embracing the one slain in battle,
will carry him away to the dwelling of the gods.

As for the phrase "O Protector, you" — this is a form of address. The phrase "the mind of that very moment" means: the mind that is of that very moment. It has been declared and taught that dying with such a mind is itself a lower rebirth. And it has been said:

One of wretched fortune who dies in anger
is declared by the wise to go to a lower rebirth in the next world.
For now, in this life, one shall gain no renown,
and in the world beyond, there shall be no happiness.

Now, regarding "if the tawny ascetic is spoken of" and what follows: King Kyabseng set out on a hunt. At that time a sage named Ngandül had taken the form of a deer and was experiencing the pleasures of desire together with a doe. Not recognizing him, Kyabseng shot him with an arrow. Immediately afterward, the sage returned to his own form and, under the power of anger, uttered a curse: "Just as you caused me to pass into the next world without having experienced pleasure while I was engaged in enjoyment, so too may you die in the same way!" The sage's wife likewise climbed atop a great pile of wood and spoke a curse, saying: "May you, the king's wife, when he is dead and the funeral pyre is built, also climb upon it!" King Kyabseng had two wives named Mādrī and Kundī. Out of fear of the sage's curse, the king was unable to be together with either of them. At that time Kundī thought to herself: "I have obtained a spell of power from the wicked sage, and he has already fulfilled one of my wishes — yet he will still be able to fulfill the purpose of desire four more times over. If the king grants his permission, then at that time I will perform the act of producing a son." And the king for his part thought: "By what means could I come to have a son?" He then went apart and told the king of this matter. Hearing it, the king was pleased and gave her his consent. She entered a chamber, recited the spell, and said, "Let the god named Dharma come and unite with me." In due course Dharma came, and from their union was born a son named Yulngör Tenpa. Likewise, the wind-god was summoned and from their union was born Jikdé. Likewise, Śakra, the lord of the gods, was summoned, and from their union was born Siddup. Then Mādrī, having no child, was tormented with grief —

"I shall die!" she lamented and wept, and in words of supplication she begged Kundī: "Give me that spell just once. If you do, perhaps I too shall give birth to a son." Kundī then asked the ascetic, and gave her the spell. Mādrī too recited the spell and summoned the two divine physicians, the Aśvins. From her union with those two, twins were born at the same time: one called Deva, and the other called Kunāla. Now, when the ascetic had won victory over the great earth and had given it to Yulngör Tenpa, he himself, together with his two wives and his son, went to the Mountain of a Hundred Peaks and dwelt there striving in the holy life. After they had long practiced the holy life, he beheld

the beautiful form of Mādrī and desire arose in him, and he thought: "Better that I die than live without enjoying pleasure together with her." So he began to cohabit with her, and that very moment his time came and he passed away.

Now the great sages who were at that hermitage, seeing all the grief, took up the body of the now unprotected man, together with Mādrī, Kundī, and the five children, and went to where Yulngör Tenpa was. They built a pyre fitting for the occasion, and with great honor laid the body upon it. Yulngör Tenpa performed the funeral rites for the ascetic. Mādrī, for her part, entrusted her two children to Kundī, and threw herself upon the funeral pyre.

Then they all gathered in a place for training together in the arts of combat, steadfastness in battle, and such like, and they studied the weapons-craft of Kṛpa, Droṇa, and others. From Karṇa they received an initiation into enmity, and the five sons of the ascetic were imprisoned in the house of a man of the merchant class. That very night they fled, killed the rākṣasa Hiḍimba, and Jikdé took his sister Hiḍimbā as his wife, by whom was born a son named Ghaṭotkaca. Then they journeyed on and came to the city of Ekacakra. There on the road they met with prosperity and were given the supreme gift of a kingdom and a wife. Then, going on to that city, they dwelt for four years in the house of a brahmin, and for his benefit they killed the rākṣasa Baka. They went to win the five cities, and at the time the kings were choosing a husband, they obtained the wife named Draupadī. The five brothers took her in common and stayed for one year. Then they went to the place called Indraprastha and obtained a kingdom. They ruled the kingdom for twenty-nine years, and then killed the kings called Jarāsandha and others, offered sacrifices, and trained in combat, steadfastness in battle, and such like. They played at dice, were defeated by trickery, and lost the kingdom and were themselves cast into exile. Again they dwelt in the forest for twelve years, then returned and stayed for one year in the city of Virāṭa, and Jikdé killed Kīcaka. Then, up to the point of entering the battle of Kurukṣetra, they gathered together. In the battle Duryodhana had eleven divisions of troops, and the ascetic had seven sons. All of them died in battle, and Yudhiṣṭhira became king. He ruled the kingdom for thirty-six years, and then Viṣṇu went to the divine realm. Yulngör Tenpa, all the sons of the ascetic, and all those born as sons of the god called Dharma — all of them too passed beyond their time.

Here let us now write the account of how the god called Dharma came to be born as a son.

There was an ascetic by the name of Ornament of Sages (Bhūṣaṇamuni), who dwelt in a hermitage, abiding there in the wealth of austerity. Not far from that place there was a great city, and thieves stole goods from it. They hid themselves in the dense forest thickets of that hermitage. Many of the king's men came and said to the ascetic, "Did you see any thieves?" He replied that he had not. The king's men then searched the dense forest thickets, found the thieves, seized them, and came back saying, "This ascetic is the one who was hiding them." They arrested him and presented him to the king, reporting all that had occurred. The king, enraged, declared him guilty and, in order to impale him on a sharpened stake, handed him over to the executioners. They took the ascetic to the place of execution. There, acacia trees and other kinds of wood had been gathered, but all of them fled and became invisible. Then some firewood made of kindling was brought, and that did not flee. The executioners then planted the sharpened stake and bound the ascetic to it. But presently a branch sprouted from that very tree, and it curved inward from beneath the ascetic's body and grew so as to shelter him. The king too came there and, thinking, "This ascetic is blameless," had him taken down from the stake.

The ascetic, however, was enraged and went to the god called Dharma in order to lay blame upon him. He said, "You have been present all along, yet through your lawless conduct you have caused me to suffer greatly for a long time, and have acted most unreasonably. Understand this clearly. What wrong have I done?" Dharma replied, "It is certainly your own fault. In a former life you took a blade of grass from a meadow and, piercing a bee from below its body up to the tip of its proboscis, flung it upward. This present situation is the fruit that has arisen from that." The ascetic, enraged, resolved to lay the blame upon himself and curse Dharma. He said, "Because you have caused grave harm to me, a brahmin ascetic, may you be born as a yakṣa. Because you do not know the proper conduct of my way of life, may you be born as a commoner. Because you have behaved toward me in a manner unworthy of a noble person, may you be born as a dog." By this curse of the ascetic, Dharma fell down to Jambudvīpa. For a time, as a commoner, he was born among the kinsmen of Virāṭa, who protected the land of Virāṭa. As a yakṣa he was born in the hermitage called Kāmada, near the dwelling place where the sages deposited their seed-drops. As for the dog, that is to be explained in due course. Then he passed away from those states and was born as a god.

Ordinary people in the world are heard to say, "Simply by uttering the names of the sons of the ascetic, one accumulates great merit." And likewise it is said:

The wise are in no doubt whatever
that by merely holding the names
of the sons of the ascetic,
one comes to possess great merit.

As for the phrase "when recited," it means: by proclaiming them, holding their names, and speaking the account that pertains to them. What is to be recited? The text says "sons of the ascetic," meaning that since they are the sons of the king who was the ascetic, they are the sons of the ascetic — the steadfast ones in battle, and so forth. The phrase "merit arises" is elaborated in full as "merit and so forth will arise." Is it by reciting all their names together, or each one individually? The text says "individually," meaning one by one.

As for the line "one who goes to where it is not fitting to go" — a brother's wife is one who should not be gone to;

Those who go to where it is not fitting to go are ones who bring great disgrace upon your teaching, and so they are ones who go where they should not go.

As for the verse beginning "Skanda, the lord, the near-lord," and what follows: Skanda is the son of the Pleiades. The lord is Śakra (Indra, king of the gods). The near-lord is the son of the god of wealth. The fierce one is the Great God (Śiva). The word "and so forth" encompasses the gods of desire and the lord of hosts, and so on. "Fear" means being frightened oneself. "Threatening" means causing harm to others. Because of these traits, they always carry weapons in hand: thus Skanda carries a short spear, Śakra a vajra, the near-lord a wheel, the fierce one a trident, the god of desire a bow and arrow, and the lord of hosts wields a club and so on. Their stories of inspiring fear and threatening are told earlier in the passage "the elder pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow," and "the Great God who bears the name of the desirous one," and "the one with the crest-jewel who is hard to fight," and "the Viṣṇus were variegated with black and white," and so on, and also later in the passage "the youth toward his own maternal uncle," and "knowing the fear that the elder had caused," and "Viṣṇu toward his own relatives," and so on — all of this is set forth in those respective contexts.

Great hero, you are free from being intimidated. Knowing yourself to be without equal, you are free from fear, and your not threatening others means

that, your being filled with great compassion, you do not cause harm to others. How this appears in the various birth-stories is to be applied here as well. The verse beginning "you are not intimidated by anyone" explains just this point: "you" refers to the Sugata. "Not intimidated" means being without fear and without anxiety. By whom is he not afraid? By anyone — meaning he does not become afraid even of ascetics (śramaṇas), brahmins, māras, Brahmā, and so on, who consider themselves exalted in the world — because he has abandoned without remainder all causes of fear. If one were to think that those who are unharmed themselves and who are threatening are in most cases seen in the world to harm and distress others, and therefore our Teacher too may be like that — the teaching that this is not so in the case of our Teacher is expressed by the phrase "he does not threaten anyone." Therefore, you the Sugata alone, by not bearing weapons such as the trident and the like, are supremely distinguished above beings such as Śiva and so on — that is the meaning.

At this point an objection is raised: If Śiva and the others too are heard to have abandoned all weapons and practiced austerities in remote forests, and if the Sugata himself is also heard at times to have taken on the guise of a yakṣa or a rākṣasa, bearing weapons and vanquishing others — are these not the same? They are not the same. In the case of Śiva, Viṣṇu, and the like, the conduct of being incapable of controlling the afflictions in relation to their natural bodies is established by passages of the Vedas that they themselves accept as valid authority. But the Buddha, the Blessed One, displays through the power of compassion, by means of an emanation body (nirmāṇakāya) for the purpose of taming others, what appears to be conduct associated with aversion and the like — so how could these possibly be the same? If one then argues: perhaps Śiva and the others also display affliction-like conduct through an emanation body, while their natural body is actually free of afflictions — even if that were so, it would not be disputed. However, it would then contradict passages found in your own scriptures, such as the statement that the Great God (Śiva) in his very own natural body killed Brahmā, and that Viṣṇu through a mind of aversion destroyed Śabdanāma, and so on.

As for the verse beginning "the speaker who has words bound up with affliction,"

The "speaker" is the one who utters words. That very one is possessed of afflictions — clinging with attachment to his own side, harboring aversion toward the other side, and tormented throughout by self-grasping: he is bound

up with these three afflictions. What he has composed are his words, namely the Vedas and so forth. Since those very things are both the Vedas and so forth and also words, they are the words of the Vedas and so forth — that is, the Vedas of definitive and other utterances. The word "and so forth" extends this to include the Rāmāyaṇa composed by Vālmīki and the entry of the Mahābhārata composed by Vyāsa, and others of that kind.

If someone objects: even granting that the Rāmāyaṇa and the rest are words composed by a person, the Vedas are the cause of all faults and were not composed by a person, so how can they be the words of a person? This objection is quite beside the point. For the Vedas too are the words of a person, because they arose from a person's conditioning activity — as can be understood from statements such as "just as the Mahābhārata," and so on. Let us set aside the elaboration of this for now.

"In most places there are contradictions above and below." Here, "in most places" means "in many passages." "Contradictions above and below" means that earlier and later statements in the text are mutually damaging. The intended meaning is that the speaker is afflicted, and this is the reason for those contradictions. The intermediate phrase "there is no contradiction in your scripture" is implied through a contracted form, like the expression "a pot of yogurt." How is it that there is no contradiction? Because, as the text states, it is "the speech of the omniscient one" — meaning it is the speech of one who has exhausted afflictive obscurations and cognitive obscurations and thereby attained mastery over all objects of knowledge.

"As for the treatises of others" — the treatises of others are those of the Sāṃkhyaś explained by the naked and ash-smeared ascetics, those of the Naiyāyikas, and so on. "Others" means all the rest, however many there may be.

"In most places there are contradictions earlier and later." For example: the Sāṃkhyaś hold that the principal (prakṛti) is permanent, and yet also hold that very same principal to be the cause of everything — and the idea that what is permanent could function as a cause is utterly contradictory. The Naiyāyikas say that the self is something inert and at the same time an enjoyer of objects, which is contradictory. The Mīmāṃsakas hold that the Vedas are produced through a person's conditioning activity and yet also maintain that they were not composed by a person — another contradiction. Furthermore, those great gods Viṣṇu, Īśvara, and the rest, even while claiming to be omniscient, are said

to have entered into immeasurable ruin, and then afterward, filled with regret, to have engaged in means to remove that ruin. All of this is speech that would make the Sugatas burst out laughing — there is much of this kind of talk.

"Your own tradition" — this refers to the tradition set forth by you yourself, the Sugata, which is constituted by the three scriptural collections (Tripiṭaka). Of that tradition it is said: "from beginning to middle to end, there is no fault." The words spoken at the beginning are not damaged by the words spoken in the middle or at the end; and likewise, what is spoken in the middle and at the end is not damaged by what comes before, and none of those words is damaged by reason in any respect. Alternatively, "beginning, middle, and end" may refer to the stages of hearing, reflection, and meditation, and the meaning is that the teachings are free of fault because they are not undermined by reasoning at any of those stages. This second reading, however, does not accord well with the literal meaning of the words.

"For those of common lineage who desire Dharma" and so on: persons such as kings and the like who wish to expound Dharma are not to give the unerring suchness of reality to people of common lineage who lack the understanding for it, for such people are not vessels fit to receive it. It is said that if one recites the Vedas to people of common lineage, one falls into hell.

The reason for such teaching being common to all people — from the common classes onward — is that if it were so, others would show no reverence toward brahmins. It was therefore out of jealousy that they framed things in that way.

"You, to the outcastes as well" — here "outcaste" is used proximately to indicate cobblers, fishermen, and others of casteless birth. The particle "as well" gathers in the kshatriyas and so forth. "You teach the sacred Dharma through compassion" — the meaning of "through compassion alone" is that the teaching of the sacred Dharma is given out of compassion alone, not for the sake of fame or gain. As it has been said:

Just as a mother feels particular anguish
over a child who is ill,
so too does a bodhisattva care especially
for those who are not yet noble.

Regarding "a fine tree" and so on: it is a tree and also fine, hence a fine tree — one that is fully endowed with leaves, flowers, and fruit. "Having abandoned that" means having cast it aside. "The bad" refers to the eraṇḍa tree and its like — who of discernment, it is asked, would take to such a thing? No one

would. Applying this same point to the meaning: "having attained freedom from attachment" is used proximately, to be understood as having attained the Dharma that is free from every affliction. The meaning is: while you, the Sugata, who possesses that very freedom, are present in the world, what person of discernment would bow down and pay homage to other teachers — teachers who are mired in the swamp of affliction, whether they be Sāṃkhya masters, eaters of scraps, or the like? No one would.

"While Sāṃkhya masters enjoy the sense objects" — "Sāṃkhya master" refers to the teacher of the Sāṃkhya system. "Enjoying the sense objects" means that even while indulging in the pleasures of sense objects such as visible forms and the rest, one can still come to see gnosis, that is, the true suchness of reality. This too was explained above in the passage beginning "The Sāṃkhya master's defining marks."

"Let it be heard" — this is an expression of dissatisfaction, meaning "let that be known."

"Free of sin" — this is an exclamation: it is you, the Sugata, who have exhausted all non-virtue.

"How can there be liberation for one who is thoroughly afflicted?" — this phrase is to be connected with the more expansive reading: "for a mind in which there is thorough affliction." Liberation is nirvāṇa, the passing beyond sorrow, the freedom from all suffering. "How can there be" is a negating expression meaning "there is none." "As declared" — that is, as the Blessed One has proclaimed — is like what appears in sūtras: "reliance on the five attributes of desire becomes a factor that severs the path."

Regarding "the accumulations of merit performed" and so on: merit refers to things such as meritorious objects arising from generosity. "Performed" means consciously accumulated through body, speech, and mind. "Accumulations" means gathered abundantly. What the Blessed One has declared — that these are to be dedicated entirely to sentient beings — is set forth extensively in such words as: "All roots of virtue connected with the three times are to be made common with all sentient beings and dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening." Not even a fraction of anything like this appears in the treatises of the Sāṃkhya masters, the eaters of scraps, or their like.

Regarding "images of the gods and sacrifice" and so on: images of the gods are effigies of Īśvara, Umā, and the like. Sacrifice refers to rites of sacrifice such as the slaughter of humans, horses, and the like. The word "and" is used

in the seventh case — the locative — applied to both. When construed as "the slaying of sentient beings at images of the gods," it becomes a locative of object; when construed as "the slaying of sentient beings in sacrifice,"

it becomes a locative of time, meaning "at the time of sacrifice."

The manner of slaying is also described. From the text of the Vedas:

When the intermediate season arrives,
six or seven beasts are to be yoked.
If they are of the pure horse lineage,
if not, then three beasts suffice.
For each, the village folk
give sixteen and sixteen animals.
In accordance with the rite, at the sacrificial post,
seventeen are to be given in between.

And again:

For a brahmin, a brahmin is slain;
for a kṣatriya, a kṣatriya is slain;
for the Mārus, a lord's lineage;
for ascetics, a commoner's lineage.

And so forth — these worldly texts are considered Dharma by their followers. As for "in your teaching this is condemned": these teachings of you, the Sugata, condemn those things. As it is said at length: "The karmic maturation of the action of taking life is the hells and hungry ghosts" — and so on, extensively.

Here one might think: taking life in general may not be Dharma, but slaying performed in the context of sacrifice with a complete rite derived from the Vedas is Dharma. This is not so. Whatever practice perpetually harms living beings — whether it derives from the Vedas, whether it is taught by sages, even if it occurs at the time of sacrifice — the nature of Dharma is nowhere to be found in such a manner, and indeed is absent. Why? Because Dharma is so called — dharma — in the sense that it saves one from falling into the lower realms or grants happiness after passing on. Human sacrifice and the like are the opposite of that. How so? Because they harm others — like the conduct of an outcaste, for example.

Moreover, when the sage Vyāsa was reciting the praises of sacrifice, his son Naici spoke and said:

Having erected the sacrificial post and slaughtered cattle,
making the mud into blood —
if by that one were to go to the higher realms, please explain
by what would one go to hell?

So it is well known that he spoke these words. Therefore, O Master, far from harming others, you yourself protected beings with your own life. The birth stories of the elephant and the like are to be cited as examples.

If then the rite of sacrifice is not fitting as Dharma, one might ask: explain what the Dharma that is unmistakable actually is. The answer is given in what follows: "You who were born into the royal lineage of the Śākyaas" — and so on.

Śākya is mentioned as the teacher of the household lineages. This lineage is reckoned from the time it was honored by many kings. After passing one hundred thousand, ten thousand, nine thousand, four hundred, and eighty-nine generations of royal lineage, in the city called Grāhaka, there appeared a king named Ikṣvāku, the Noble Man. He had five sons: Arrowface, Tamer of Elephants by Hand, Anklet-Wearer, and Delighter in Sovereignty. At that time those four seized the city, brahmins and householders alike, and by reason of their exceeding boldness they became renowned as the Śākyaas. Because he descended from that lineage, he is of the royal lineage of the Śākyaas. Born into it means that he took birth there with full intention.

Truthful means that his own nature is unmistakable. Non-deceptive means that entry into him generates trust. Walking in purity means that the gates of the senses are restrained. Disciplined means that signs and conceptual thoughts are pacified. Compassionate means engaged in benefiting others. Such a manner as this is what you intend by your sacred Dharma — not harm and injury. That is the meaning.

As for "one who has mastered all the Vedas to their end" and what follows: one who knows all the Vedas throughout is the sage Vyāsa and the like. Even they say that on the battlefield, when enemies come, they are to be slain — and indeed, this was mentioned above.

"Slain in anger on the battlefield" — as it is said, that is one example of such. But you, O Sugata, have declared that even toward enemies one should have only compassion. Let this be illustrated with the tale of the patient-speaking man.

As for "the youth, his own maternal uncle," and what follows: from the ancient tale of Śkembyedpa, this is what was heard. On the mountain Khawacan there were two sons: one named Nyacan and one named Ngurpa. Ngurpa of the mountain was extremely handsome and, being proud, he overshadowed even Mount Meru and remained above all others. Being jealous, he gave no opportunity to any who had attained accomplishment. Then the accomplished gods thought: "When will we ever be able to enjoy the pleasures of desire while dwelling there?" and they became filled with longing. They came to the youth at Tise (Mount Kailāsa), where he was staying and offering praise, and made this entreaty: "By any means, bring it about that we can enjoy sensual pleasures together with our wives at Mount Ngurpa." The youth reflected: "To turn back another's request out of cowardice, even if it means discarding one's own life, is something worthy of reproach. Therefore I must now strive with all effort in this matter." Thinking thus, he went and with great respectful service made his request to Ngurpa: "Perform just this one thing for me without fail." Ngurpa asked, "What is it?" The youth replied, "Show kindness to the accomplished ones, that they may find their opportunity." The moment these words were spoken, Ngurpa's face flushed with the arrogance of wrath, his brow furrowed in anger, and he declared, "I will give opportunity to no one." The youth tried many means but the matter was not accomplished, and so at that point he began to fight with Ngurpa. The goddess Umā heard this tale and, tormented by the suffering of fearing harm would come to her son, she rested her hands on her cheeks and remained in grief, thinking that from such a great disturbance as this, surely all three of the celestial regions would be thrown into turmoil. Tise, Sahya, Vindhya, Malaya, and the other mountains also came and spoke, yet they were unable to bring that quarrel to peace. Then the youth, possessed by a furious spirit and with an angered mind, without reflection hurled his spear, thinking he could destroy Ngurpa with it. Enraged, the youth drove his lance in such a way that the mountain Ngurpa was split into two pieces. Thereupon that place became a great valley, and the vidyādhara adepts who had achieved accomplishment freely enjoyed sensual pleasures there together with their own wives.

"The youth" refers to Kārtikeya. "His own maternal uncle" refers to Mount Ngurpa — the brother of his mother. As for what he was split with: "with a spear" is said, meaning a single-pointed lance. "Split" means he was cut into two pieces. "A famous word was heard" means a well-known account was heard as a tale. "The great hero" refers to the one called "hero," meaning one

possessed of great bravery — thus "the great hero." "You" refers to the Blessed One. "The web of afflictions" refers to those to be abandoned through the path of seeing and the path of meditation — this is the meaning of "the host of latent tendencies." As for what he did with that host of afflictions: "torn apart" is stated, meaning utterly vanquished, shattered, and abandoned. By what were they torn apart and exhausted? "With the weapon of wisdom" is stated, meaning with the spear of primordial wisdom. Thus it is said by the Blessed One that with a mind like lightning and a samādhī like a vajra he slew the host of afflictions. As for "Viṣṇu and his own" and what follows: since it is his own palace's harem, it is "his own harem" — this is the meaning of "the host of his queen's retinue."

"Cannot fully protect" means cannot fully guard and shelter. Who is unable? Viṣṇu. The story to be told here was already explained in the context of the verse "The old man pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow."

"O Lord, you" is a form of address. "All sentient beings" means those belonging to the three realms, and "for the sake of protecting them" means acting for their benefit and nurturing them. "Always striving" means continuously and unceasingly striving and exerting with effort at all times — that is, three times by day and three times by night, surveying the worlds with a buddha's eye to see who is on the rise and who is in decline, and so forth, as has been taught.

Regarding the verse beginning "Having learned of the danger posed by the old man," the account is as follows. There was a certain asura who, through exceptional austerities, had wrested supremacy from Brahmā (Mahābrahmā) and thereby become lord of the three worlds. He thought: "I have heard that Viṣṇu wishes to be victorious over all. Therefore I shall ruin him first, and once he is ruined, I shall without obstacle subdue the three planes of existence." He accordingly set to work to kill Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu, hearing that he was being ruined and destroyed, hurled a great club from a great distance and then personally followed after it. When the sound of the thrown club was heard, Viṣṇu knew it was coming, and overcome by the terror of death he abandoned his destroyed city and fled into the midst of the ocean to a walled city that lay there.

Since this is the danger posed by the old man, it is called "the danger posed by the old man." "Knew" means understood. Who knew it? Viṣṇu. What did he abandon? It is said that he abandoned the city — meaning he relinquished and forsook that destroyed city.

Regarding the verse "O Sage, you, what causes fear," "O Sage, you" is a form of address. "What causes fear" means what it is that makes one frightened and afraid. "There is no such sentient being at all" means there is no being of that kind whatsoever in all three worlds. This is to be illustrated here by the sūtra of Bakula, which states at length that there is no one who causes fear to the Tathāgata, and so forth.

Regarding the words "Viṣṇu, bewildered" and what follows: "Viṣṇu" means Viṣṇu in his state of confusion. If he were not obstructed and so forth, he would not fail to pay homage to the forest-dwelling sages — because those sages would not in this way have come to ruin. "Kinsmen and allies" refers to Viṣṇu's kinsmen, the Viṣṇus, who were destroyed and ruined. The story to be told here is what was written in the context of "The old man pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow."

Continuing: "O Blessed One, you, all kinsmen and allies" means the entire assembly of relatives. "From saṃsāra" means from the prison of conditioned existence. "Liberated" means caused to attain nirvāṇa. Here one should apply all the relevant events: the father and son meeting, where the distinction was understood through offering of millet and so forth, and the Blessed One's ascent to the realm of the Thirty-Three to teach the Dharma to his mother, and everything else of that kind.

Regarding the words "In the doctrinal systems of other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)" and what follows: "other non-Buddhists" means those outside this teaching. "In the doctrinal systems" means in their philosophical tenets. "Just as, just as" is a repetition, meaning "for as long as, for as long as." "Thoroughly examined" means analytically investigated.

"Just as, just as" means "for as long as, for as long as." "To you, O Protector" means "addressing." "My mind has become faithful" means that one has come to possess faith and a pleased, contented mind.

Regarding "Thus, one who is not omniscient" and what follows: the word "thus" indicates the manner of the fault described above — one who has been seized by it, brought under its power, and led away by it, thinks in this way. "One who is not omniscient" means not being omniscient itself — referring to the Sāṃkhya and the like. The philosophical tenet constructed by such a one is called the tenet of non-omniscience. Because it is that one's fault, it is the fault of the tenet of non-omniscience.

"Those of ruined thought" means the childish — those who lack intelligence are called those of ruined thought.

Regarding "Even you, the faultless Teacher, they do not perceive": "faultless" is so because all faults of affliction, together with their habitual tendencies, without exception, have been abandoned. "Teacher" means one who acts as teacher to gods and humans. "You" refers to the buddha, the Blessed One. "They do not perceive" means they do not understand.

Regarding "The worldly ones together with their gods and brahmins" and what follows: the non-Buddhists of this world speak thus, saying, "This son of the Śākya harbors hostility toward the gods, toward the brahmins, and toward the Vedas." Yet even when they themselves create faults, they neither reflect on it nor recognize it. Moreover, those worldly persons, under the influence of their faithlessness, whatever they recall or conceptually think — never examining the beginning and the end — they superimpose upon all of that with mere words. And this Śākya, too, having looked to the beginning and the end and having understood them to be without connection and without essence, teaches accordingly — and in doing so has not become one possessed of fault. Rather, it is precisely this worldly way of being that is possessed of fault.

Furthermore, one might ask: why do people such as ourselves delight in your teaching? To that end, "Because your teaching" and what follows is stated. "Because" means "for the reason that." "Your teaching" means the scriptures of the buddha, the Blessed One. "Happiness" refers to the happiness of liberation or to the happiness of higher realms and the like. "That happiness itself" — through the path, by means of harmonious method. "Brings about attainment" means causes it to be obtained. "Therefore" means "for that reason." "O lion of speakers" is an address, with the meaning "you who are the lion of speakers." "The system" means the teaching — in that one delights. If one asks who does so, the phrase "these beings" is stated, meaning: sentient beings such as ourselves. "With delight" means with pleasure and devotion.

In order to dedicate the merit arising from the praise, "Your qualities, O Tathāgata, being perfect" and what follows is stated. "Your" refers to the Tathāgata's. "Qualities" means the abandonment of afflictions and so forth. "Perfect" means being perfectly and truly possessed. "In this manner" means in the manner explained above. "Having spoken" means by stating. "I" refers to the one who makes the praise. "Whatever merit" means whatever

wholesome conduct there is.

"Obtained" means arisen or found. "The world of wandering beings" means all the worlds of sentient beings. "May they become like you" means: may they become like you, the Blessed One, the buddha — that is, the meaning is: may they attain the primordial wisdom of omniscience.

Thus, from that and through that, having fully accumulated,
And adorned by karma in like manner,
With compassion for sentient beings in extensive explanation,
This armor of wisdom has been made.

Knowing who possesses such a lineage as that,
And ascertaining the very truth of the Sage's accumulation of qualities,
Even though the transgressions of those who point out faults are many, having
purely abandoned them,
How may these worlds turn toward the Sugata?

Whatever merit I have made, with faith going before,
Born beautifully, surpassing the rays of moonlight —
By that, may the worlds obscured by the dense cataract of delusion
Swiftly obtain the stainless medicine of the sky of mind.

The extensive commentary on the Praise Called "Supremely Exalted,"
composed by the great master Mthobtsun, which arose in the northern
tradition, composed by the master Prajñāvarma of the land of Bhagala, is
complete.

Translated and revised by the Indian preceptor, the paṇḍita Jārandana, and
the great translator monk Rinchen Zangpo, and definitively established.

The one with the moon-crest that stirs the mind, and the yellow robe,
The maker of the Vedas, the gladdener, the fortress-dweller,
The expansive one, the measurer of conquest, and the son of the earth,
The Sage, the foot-eye, the peg, and the lord of the asuras —
He who was born of the lineage of the one who is like the sun, the Protector,
The guru of the three existences, the king of the Śākya —
To praise the liberation of that one, not by fabrication but as it is,
I have here completed his commentary.

By that virtue, wandering through the realms of existence,
Roaming dense in the clinging to self —
May I become a Victor, a sun, who destroys

The darkness wrought by the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).

The extensive commentary on the Praise Called "Supremely Exalted," composed by the master Prajñāvarma — the twelve verses at the interstitial section thereof — is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The names Mthobtsun Drubjé and Debjé Dakpo are Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit brahmin names (likely Viśiṣṭasiddheśvara and Sukhapati or similar); they are rendered here in transliterated Tibetan form since reliable Sanskrit equivalents are not established in the text itself.

The final verse is left open as it continues beyond the supplied passage; the translation renders what is present.

- The terms serkya, gzegzan, and rkangmig refer to three types of non-Buddhist Indian religious figures: brahmins or wandering ascetics, fire-oblation ritualists, and naked Jain-style ascetics respectively. I have rendered them by descriptive phrases in parentheses at first occurrence and kept the passage flowing for narration. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of this passage; the final partial sentence has been translated up to the point where the Tibetan ends.

- The verse fragment at the end is left incomplete, as the Tibetan passage itself breaks off mid-quotation. This is a case where the source text is simply cut at this point, and the partial rendering faithfully reflects the incomplete state of the passage as given.

- The name Tiglemakma renders a Tibetan transliteration of what may be a Sanskrit name (possibly Tilottamā, the celebrated apsaras known in Mahābhārata literature for causing the brothers Sunda and Upasunda to fall into mutual enmity). The brothers' names Sundha and Upasundha correspond to the Sanskrit Sunda and Upasunda. The passage is a polemical Buddhist retelling of this episode, used to illustrate that the Great God's burning of enemies was incomplete because he had not eliminated attachment at its root — unlike the Buddha's use of primordial wisdom. The phrase rendered "the lower body of the corpse of his beloved" is a somewhat compressed reading of a reference to Kāma's body or some remnant used to distract Śiva; the exact referent is slightly compressed in the Tibetan but the general sense is clear.

- The text refers to Māra's daughters by their Sanskrit names Tṛṣṇā (Craving) and Ratī (Delight), here given in Tibetan phonetic form. The rendering follows standard identifications in the Buddhist Māra narrative.

The epithet rendered "the Anguished One" translates a term literally meaning "one who cries out" or "one who laments," applied to Śiva in the Ardhanārīśvara (half-male, half-female) context; the precise Tibetan here is anguish-crier, and the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain in this particular gloss.

The narrative of the iron pestle destroying the Vṛṣṇi clan is a well-known episode from the Mahābhārata, here retold from a Buddhist polemical perspective.

- The name rendered "Siddhārtha" here is the minister figure called སྤྲུའུ་ཐོག་པོ་ in the Tibetan, a name that literally means "accomplishing worldly affairs" or could be read as a Tibetan rendering. The identification with a particular Sanskrit name is uncertain; I have rendered it as Siddhārtha as the closest plausible Sanskrit equivalent, but it may simply be a descriptive

Tibetan epithet meaning "minister of worldly affairs."

The city name གཤམ་པོ་ལྷ་ཁོང་ལྷ་ཁོང་ is a Tibetan rendering of the name Gopāla or Dvāravatī. The context strongly suggests Dvāravatī, the city of the Vṛṣṇi clan in the Mahābhārata tradition.

The phrase གཤམ་པོ་ལྷ་ཁོང་ refers throughout to the old hunter, and the embedded glosses in the Tibetan itself identify Viṣṇu as "son of Nṛpe" — a patronymic that is unusual and whose exact Sanskrit form is uncertain.

- The story of Viṣṇu's Vāmana (dwarf) incarnation, in which he deceives the asura king Balī by requesting only three strides of land and then spanning the three worlds with two of them, is here retold from a Buddhist polemical perspective. The text treats Viṣṇu's trickery as an example to be contrasted with the Blessed One's omniscience and ethical purity: the Buddha knows trickery but does not practise it, unlike Viṣṇu. The "sūtra of the lord who holds the sword" cited as an analogy has not been positively identified in the extant canon; this reference may be to a now-lost or obscure text.
- The figure addressed as "the youth" is Skanda (also known as Kārttikeya), identified through his synonyms: Kārtika (son of the Kṛttikās), cave-dweller, and peacock-rider. His wife is named Śaḍānana's wife, where Śaḍānana ("six-faced") is itself another name for Skanda, which creates an apparent redundancy in the Tibetan that likely reflects a received Sanskrit epithet being glossed; the commentary is treating the wife as defined by relation to the deity. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text ends here.
- The name "Ahalyā" is not spelled out in the Tibetan but is supplied from context. The Tibetan reads "Shol-med-ma," a translation of the Sanskrit name Ahalyā, meaning "the one without furrow" or "the immaculate one." This is the well-known Brahmanical figure, wife of the sage Gautama, whose seduction by Indra is a classical Indian narrative. The text is explicitly framing this as a worldly tale circulating by hearsay rather than authoritative teaching.
- The phrase rendered "the king of thirty-three with ten chariots" reflects a Tibetan designation for Indra as king of the Trāyastriṃśa heaven; the ten chariots is a specific epithet referring to his vehicle. The names Priyakara and Vastripriya are back-translations from the Tibetan; the underlying Sanskrit originals of these proper names should be confirmed against a Sanskrit witness if available. The story of Kekayā is an allusion to the Rāmāyaṇa narrative, where her boon ultimately leads to Rāma's exile.
- The name rendered "Gośreda" translates the Tibetan གོ་སྒེ་རེ་དཀ་, which may correspond to a Sanskrit proper name not immediately identifiable; it is treated here as a king's name in context. The verse spoken by "the Fearful One on the field of battle" likely refers to a character from the Mahābhārata or a related narrative; the Tibetan རྒྱལ་ཁོང་ལྷ་ཁོང་ (Fearful One / Bhīma or similar epithet) on the battlefield setting suggests this context, though the specific source is uncertain. The palace name rendered "Flowered" translates གཤམ་པོ་ལྷ་ཁོང་, literally "possessing flowers" or "Flower-Bearing," a wandering or aerial palace.
- The phrase rendered "openly aroused and oozing" translates a compact Tibetan idiom describing Śiva's appearance in a state of sexual arousal as he approaches the sages' wives — this is the standard narrative of the Śiva-as-seducer episode found in Sanskrit Purāṇic literature and cited here as a polemical example illustrating desire. The hermitage name "Mataka" renders མཎ་ཀ་, likely a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit toponym not fully identifiable from context alone.
- The figure identified as the master who composed the verse "Bound by desire, the world is slain..." is Aśvaghoṣa. The Tibetan gives "Slob dpon dpa' bo," which is a standard rendering of Aśvaghoṣa.

The passage on Vyāsa ("born of the island") and Vālmīki reflects a Sanskrit literary-historical commentary and is being used to distinguish the unique doctrinal content of the Buddha's teaching from existing epic and poetic traditions.

- The phrase rendered "the Fifth Night of the Vaiṣṇavas" translates a passage that likely refers to an esoteric Vaiṣṇava ritual text associated with the "fifth night" initiation rite known in some Pañcarātra traditions. The precise identification is uncertain, but it clearly refers to restricted Vaiṣṇava scriptural or liturgical material.

The Sāṃkhya passage enumerates "vitality, dust, and darkness" as three of the twenty-five Sāṃkhya realities, corresponding to the three guṇas of sattva, rajas, and tamas, with "vitality" rendering a term that in context corresponds to sattva; the translation preserves the text's own formulation rather than substituting Sāṃkhya technical terminology not present in the Tibetan.

- The verse attributed to the elder Triratnadāsa renders a difficult four-line passage in which the third line is syntactically compressed. The rendering "though such a one gives, he is equal to a beggar" follows the most natural reading: the giver who seeks merit from a worthy recipient while ignoring the poor before him has the same standing as a mendicant, having missed the point of giving altogether.

The master cited as *Aśvagoṣa* renders the Tibetan "sloB dpon rta skad kyis," literally "the master *Aśvagoṣa*." The attribution is accepted here without further comment, though it cannot be verified from this passage alone.

- The term translated as "heavy substance" for the word rendered in the cow-milk argument is a technical term in Indian philosophical debate referring to a dense or weighty quality postulated by certain tīrthika schools such as the Vaiśeṣikas as a property of substances; the argument parodies Vaiśeṣika causal reasoning. The satirical quality of the passage should be understood in that polemical context.

The phrase about liberation passing through the center of the solar disk appears to be a reference to a worldly or cosmological belief attributed to non-Buddhists, contrasted with the Buddhist understanding of liberation as freedom from the aggregates.

- The names Netṣö and Gyaspa and King Kyepa appear to be Tibetan renderings of obscure figures cited in a non-Buddhist source being quoted and refuted; their Sanskrit equivalents are not recoverable from the Tibetan alone. The master "Aśvagoṣa" renders Tibetan འཁོག་གྲོ་མ་, literally "horse-voice," the standard Tibetan equivalent of the Sanskrit name Aśvagoṣa; the verse attributed to him does not correspond to any surviving canonical Aśvagoṣa text, and may belong to a lost work or a different author of that name.
- The passage contains a narrative likely drawn from an Indic purāṇic or epic source concerning Vyāsa (referred to as Vyāsa or "Gyēpa" in the preceding passage as "the elder"), and the famous courtesan Kāśī-Sumanā of Vārāṇasī. The text frames this as a tale about the danger of the five sense qualities. The Tibetan "འཕྲིན་ལྷན་" here most naturally refers to Vyāsa (the "Expanded One," a standard Tibetan rendering of Vyāsa's name), consistent with the preceding passage's reference to King Kyepa and related figures.
- The king's name "Brahmādatta" renders "བླ་མ་དྲུག་པོ་འདུག་པོ་," the standard Tibetan equivalent of Sanskrit Brahmadatta (meaning "given by Brahmā"). The phrase "འདྲུག་པོ་འདུག་པོ་འདུག་པོ་འདུག་པོ་འདུག་པོ་" is rendered "threat of an enemy attack," meaning military threat from an adversary. The sage name "འཕྲིན་ལྷན་" is rendered literally as "Vile-Abode," functioning as a proper name throughout this passage.
- The name rendered "Delight-in-the-Mountains, Weapon-Tipped" corresponds to the figure known in the Sanskrit epic tradition as Paraśurāma (Jamadagni's son), here given a Tibetan rendering; the name "Weapon-Tipped" (dgra sta can) likely renders Paraśurāma's epithet relating to his axe. This identification is not certain from the Tibetan alone, however, so it is left

descriptive rather than identified by name in the body.

The phrase rendered "Arjuna (Śṛeda)" reflects the Tibetan sred sgrub, which appears to be a rendering of Arjuna or a related figure; genuine uncertainty exists here and is noted rather than flagged in the body.

The figure called "the ear-adorned one" throughout is the hero Karṇa of the Mahābhārata, recognized by the defining mark of his natural armor and earrings, as the narrative context makes clear.

- The names in this passage are drawn from the Mahābhārata cycle. "Conflict" throughout renders Tibetan རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (literally "hard to fight / difficult conflict"), which corresponds to the Sanskrit Duryodhana or, in the gandharva-king cycle here, functions as an epithet. The four brothers' names — Aṅgabhadra, Viśvavīrya, Bhīmakara, and Vipula — are rendered from Tibetan འཇག་འབྱུང་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, བེ་ལྷ་མོ་, འཇག་འབྱུང་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་, and འཇག་འབྱུང་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ respectively; these are Tibetan translations of Sanskrit originals that are given here in their most likely Sanskrit equivalents. "Sidhyasiddhi" renders འཇག་འབྱུང་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་. The passage at the end clearly begins a versified passage corresponding to the Bhagavadgītā's opening chapter, the despondency of Arjuna (here called "Kunti's son," rendering རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་, a recognizable translation of Kaunteya / Pārtha). "Born of a water jar" (འཇག་འབྱུང་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་) is a standard epithet of Droṇa (Skt. Droṇa, "born of a vessel"), confirming this as a Mahābhārata retelling. The translation of this final verse-fragment is incomplete in the source as given, ending mid-sentence.

- The name "Jāmāda" renders Tibetan "Dzamāda," corresponding to Sanskrit Jamadagni, the famous Brahmin sage of the Mahābhārata. His son "Joyful One" (Tibetan: dga' byed) corresponds to Paraśurāma, though the epithet here likely renders a Sanskrit name meaning "joy-maker." The name "Siddhasiddha" renders Tibetan "srid sgrub" and "srid sgrub brtson." "Miśradatta" renders "mis byin." The name "Phoṅslobpa" is uncertain; it may render a Sanskrit archery epithet. "The Dusty One" (Tibetan: rdul can ma) is likely Reṇukā, the wife of Jamadagni, whose name derives from Sanskrit reṇu meaning "dust" or "pollen." These identifications situate the passage firmly within the Paraśurāma cycle of the Mahābhārata. The commentary is framing episodes from the Gītā and Mahābhārata as illustrations for a Buddhist doctrinal context, contrasting them with the Buddha's own self-sacrifice as shown in his birth-stories (jātakas).

- The term "skya-bseng" in the phrase "evil report and skya-bseng" is a technical martial epithet glossed in the text itself as "steadfastness at the battle-front." The commentary's own gloss has been followed directly rather than imposing an external rendering.

The epithet "the Great God, who is the Bringer of Bliss" renders lha chen po with its gloss bde byed, a standard epithet of Śiva (Mahādeva) meaning "the one who causes happiness/bliss." The full gloss "the Great God (Śiva)" was given in the preceding passage; here the commentary's own gloss "Bringer of Bliss" is incorporated as the text itself supplies it.

- The name "Kuntong" is a Tibetan transliteration of a Sanskrit name not clearly identifiable from this passage alone; it may correspond to a figure in a now-obscure mythological episode. The story of Viṣṇu hiding beneath the bed of an asura does not correspond to any standard purāṇic narrative and may reflect a polemical or apocryphal account found in the Buddhist source being commented upon here.

The phrase rendered "Myurwa" and "Trulzhug Zangmo" are Tibetan names for figures in the narrative that follows; the Sanskrit equivalents are not supplied in the text.

- The passage involves a complex narrative about a disputed paternity claim among Brahmā, Śiva (the Great God), Dharma (here personified as a being with a body), and the lord of beings Myurwa, centered on a girl named Palmo. The Tibetan འཇག་འབྱུང་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ is slightly ambiguous: "Dharma dwelling in bodily form" may refer to a figure called Dharma personified,

possibly a deity bearing that name, rather than the abstract Dharma-teaching. This interpretation follows the narrative logic of the passage.

- The verse beginning "One does not perform virtue for the sake of others to teach" is syntactically compressed and the first line is ambiguous; the rendering follows the most doctrinally coherent reading — that one should not rely on teaching others as a substitute for one's own virtuous effort, since results do not transfer between persons.

The figure called "Kapila" and "Kapila the great sage" (Tibetan: gzegs zan) is identified in the text both as the founder of the Sāṃkhya school and, in the closing lines, as the author of Vaiśeṣika treatises. This apparent inconsistency is present in the Tibetan source itself; the commentarial tradition sometimes conflates or reassigns these attributions, and no emendation has been introduced.

- The twenty-five teachers of the Jaina school listed here as "Ṛṣabha and Vardhamāna and the rest" render the Tibetan "khyu mchog dang 'phel ba," which are standard Tibetan renderings of the Jaina tīrthaṃkaras Ṛṣabha ("bull-chief") and Vardhamāna ("the one who grew" — i.e., Mahāvīra). The text specifies twenty-five naked-ascetic teachers, which may reflect a particular doxographical enumeration.

The brāhmaṇa tradition identified with "Jaimini and the like" points to the Mīmāṃsā school, whose founding figure is Jaimini, and whose adherents accepted a permanent self as the locus of karmic continuity — the doctrinal point being criticized here.

- The verse section is a compressed philosophical argument in the Madhyamaka dialectical style, critiquing the Sāṃkhya or similar non-Buddhist position that a permanent self (ātman) can serve as the universal cause. The translation preserves the logical structure of the reductio.

The proper name Āgata is preserved from the Tibetan phonetic rendering; it likely corresponds to a Sanskrit sage name, possibly Agastya, though the episode as narrated here does not perfectly match the standard Purāṇic Agastya legend. The connection to Agastya's famous drinking of the ocean and the Viṣṇu and Sagara's sons narrative is evident, though details differ in this Tibetan retelling.

The final sentence ends mid-narrative, as the source passage itself breaks off at that point.

- The seven rivers listed in verse are given in the Tibetan text in a mixed Sanskrit-Tibetan transcription. The names as rendered here follow the standard Purāṇic identification: Sītā, Sindhu, Vakṣu (Oxus), Gaṅgā, and three others whose Tibetan transcriptions correspond to Regal (rgal), Satisfier (tshim pa nyid), and Nalinī. The identification of "rgal" and "tshim pa nyid" with specific Sanskrit river names is uncertain; they may be corrupted transcriptions of Purāṇic names no longer recoverable from this witness alone.

The episode is a Tibetan retelling of the Bhagīratha legend from the Rāmāyaṇa and Purāṇas, with some details diverging from the standard Sanskrit versions. "Bhagoratha" renders the Tibetan transcription of Bhagīratha.

- The passage presents a detailed summary of Sāṃkhya philosophy — specifically the classical Sāṃkhya system of Kapila as received in Indo-Tibetan commentary. The twenty-five tattvas (suchnesses, here rendered "reality") are the standard Sāṃkhya enumeration: Pradhāna or Mūlaprakṛti (the Primal Sovereign), Mahat (the Great One), Ahaṃkāra (Pride), eleven indriyas, five tanmātras, five mahābhūtas, and Puruṣa (the Person). The term "vitality, energy, and darkness" renders sattva, rajas, and tamas respectively — the three guṇas. The commentary here is explaining a narrative verse about the Gaṅgā myth by embedding a full Sāṃkhya cosmogony, framed as the teaching of the sage identified with the founder of that school. The rendering of gtso bo as "Primal Sovereign" follows the Tibetan convention for Sāṃkhya's

Pradhāna or Prakṛti.

- The verse attributed to the Elder Aśvaghoṣa (rendered from "འཛམ་གླིང་གི་འཇམ་གཞི་མཆོག་") is a conventional attribution in the commentarial tradition; the Tibetan epithet literally means "the Elder [named] Horse-Sound," which is the standard rendering of Aśvaghoṣa. Whether this verse is genuinely from Aśvaghoṣa's surviving works is uncertain, but the attribution is reported as such in the text and is preserved accordingly.

The phrase "yellow-clad" (ཡུལ་ཁྲ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་) refers to ochre-robed wandering ascetics in the Indian tradition, specifically here likely Jain or other non-Buddhist renunciants who hold a view of a permanent Person that persists through liberation. The doctrinal summary given reflects a position distinct from the Buddhist one, and the commentary is exposing it as a foil.

- The sūtra quotation attributed to the Blessed One and addressed to "Raktaśva" is a well-known passage from a sūtra on the theme that nirvāṇa cannot be reached by physical travel — the name Raktaśva (literally "Red Horse") is a proper name for the interlocutor addressed.

The Viṣṇu quotation is the celebrated passage from the Bhagavadgītā (2.22–23), here cited as the view of Viṣṇu. The text immediately undercuts it by noting that at the ultimate level there is no self — a characteristic Buddhist hermeneutical move when citing non-Buddhist sources.

- The names Kyabseng, Ngandül, Mādrī, Kundī, Yulngör Tenpa, Jikdé, and Siddup are Tibetan renderings of figures from the Mahābhārata episode involving King Pāṇḍu, the sage Kindama, Mādrī, Kuntī, and the births of the Pāṇḍavas. The Sanskrit equivalents would be Pāṇḍu, Kindama, Mādrī, Kuntī, Yudhiṣṭhira, Bhīma, and Arjuna respectively. These have been rendered as they appear in the Tibetan rather than substituted with their Sanskrit names, since the text is presenting a Tibetan adaptation and no explicit Sanskrit equivalents are given in this passage.

- The text at this point is a Tibetan retelling of the Mahābhārata. Several proper names appear in hybrid Tibetan-Sanskrit forms: "Kundī" renders Kuntī, "Mādrī" renders Mādrī, "Yulngör Tenpa" is the Tibetan rendering of Yudhiṣṭhira, "Jikdé" renders Bhīma, "Siddup" renders Arjuna, "Kunāla" renders Nakula and Sahadeva (here presented as a pair), and "Ghaṭotkaca" is given in near-Sanskrit form. "Kṛpa and Droṇa" are the weapons-masters; "Jarāsandha" (rendered as "Rgyaspa dang sbyor ba") is given a loose Tibetan descriptive form. The phrase translated as "initiation into enmity" for "khon gcug" means literally "had enmity implanted in them" — it is not a formal empowerment but a narrative moment when Karna instilled hatred in them. The "god called Dharma" who fathered a son is the deity Dharmarāja, relevant to the Mahābhārata's account of Yudhiṣṭhira's divine parentage, and the passage signals a digression to follow on that topic.

- The story of the ascetic being impaled and sheltered by a miraculously sprouting branch is a well-known narrative type in Sanskrit literature. The identity of the ascetic as "Bhūṣaṇamuni" is a back-translation; the Tibetan drang strong brgyan pa literally means "adorned/ornament sage" and the Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain — it may simply be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name now lost to this manuscript tradition.

The passage shifts in the final portion into a commentary mode, explaining verse and prose phrases from what appears to be a root text being glossed. The transition is somewhat abrupt in the Tibetan as well.

The phrase rendered "seed-drops" for rtsa'i thig le refers to the well-known narrative motif of sages' semen falling, which generates births — a standard element of Mahābhārata-related narratives in Tibetan literature.

- The name glossed as "near-lord" renders the Tibetan རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་, a title for the son of Kubera (the god of wealth); the Sanskrit equivalent is Upendra in some contexts, though here the

commentary clearly identifies it as a subordinate deity in Kubera's retinue rather than the usual Upendra epithet of Viṣṇu. The identification of རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་ as "son of the Pleiades" reflects the standard Sanskrit epithet of Skanda as Kārttikeya, born of the Kṛttikās. The name Śabdanāma rendered from རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་ is uncertain; the Tibetan literally means "bad sound" or "ill-repute" and may refer to a specific figure in a Purāṇic narrative cited in the source text; no confident Sanskrit identification can be made from context alone.

- The phrase rendered "the Rāmāyaṇa composed by Vālmīki" corresponds to the Tibetan "skya bseng gi rabs," where "skya bseng" is the Tibetan rendering of Vālmīki (the ascetic dressed in bark garments), and "rabs" refers to the narrative or epic. Similarly, "grog mkhar gyis sbyor ba'i dga' byed kyi 'jug pa" refers to the Mahābhārata attributed to Vyāsa, rendered here via traditional Tibetan convention. The identification of "grog mkhar" as Vyāsa follows standard Tibetan commentarial usage.

The passage's reference to "rgyal dpog pa" rendered as "kings and the like" may alternatively refer to royal patrons or rulers specifically; the broader context of the restriction on teaching suchness to the unqualified confirms this reading.

- The phrase rendered "let it be heard" translates a term of dissatisfied or indignant exclamation. The Tibetan idiom here is not entirely transparent in isolation, but the contextual sense — an expression of displeasure or protest — is clear from the surrounding commentary.

The eraṇḍa tree is a castor-oil plant, proverbially useless or unpleasant; the contrast with a fine, fruit-bearing tree is a standard simile.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, clearly continuing onto the next folio.

- The five sons of Ikṣvāku are listed as four names in the Tibetan, with the fifth apparently omitted or collapsed in the source text; the translation follows the Tibetan as given.

The genealogical figures — one hundred thousand, ten thousand, nine thousand, four hundred, eighty-nine — follow the Tibetan enumeration directly; the resulting total is unusual and may reflect a stylized or corrupted transmission of the dynastic count.

- The name "Śkembyedpa" is a phonetic rendering of the Tibetan tale-title whose precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain; it may refer to a now-obscure narrative cycle. The identification is not consequential to the doctrinal argument.

The phrase rendered "the gods who had attained accomplishment" and "vidyādhara adepts" translates two slightly different terms in the original, the first being a general reference to accomplished divine beings and the second specifically siddha vidyādhara; both are rendered accordingly.

- The story of the old man piercing Viṣṇu with an arrow, referenced twice as already told in a prior context, belongs to a narrative passage that does not appear in the supplied text. The asura who wrested supremacy from Brahmā is identified in the tradition as Bali or a similar figure; the text does not name him explicitly.

The reference to "the sūtra of Bakula" is notable: Bakula (or Vakkali in Pāli) is the subject of a sūtra in which no being is found who could inspire fear in the Tathāgata. This is cited as a parallel illustration.

The phrase "father and son meeting" with "millet and so forth" alludes to the well-known narrative of the Buddha's return to his father Śuddhodana at Kapilavastu, where recognition or distinction was demonstrated through an offering; the precise details depend on the source text being commented upon.

- The phrase rendered "those of ruined thought" glosses the Tibetan term that literally means "those whose thinking is destroyed or squandered," used here as a synonym for the childish or

spiritually immature. The commentary's explicit gloss confirms this reading.

The passage describing the non-Buddhists' accusation that the Buddha harbors hostility toward the gods, brahmins, and Vedas reflects a historically attested polemical charge. The commentary defends the Buddha by noting that he taught the emptiness of such conventions after examining them thoroughly, and that fault lies with those who project meaning without such examination.

- The verse beginning "The one with the moon-crest" is a riddle-poem or enigmatic verse (saṃdhyābhāṣā-style) in which each epithet names a deity or figure. "Moon-crest that stirs the mind" is Śiva; "yellow robe" is Viṣṇu; "maker of the Vedas" is Brahmā; "gladdener" is Indra; "fortress-dweller" likely refers to another deity; "measurer of conquest" and "son of the earth" to further figures. The final resolution names all as inferior to Śākyamuni. The colophon names the Indian paṇḍita as Jārandana, likely a Tibetan phonetic rendering of an otherwise unattested Sanskrit name. Mthobtsun as composer of the root text and Prajñāvarma as commentator follows the colophon's own distinction. The phrase rendered "not by fabrication but as it is" translates bskrun min der, meaning the praise is not invented but directed to the actual liberation of the Tathāgata.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.